

EVERY SINGLE NIGHT

BY

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Inspired by real lovers.

EXT. MISSISSIPPI RIVER - LATE AFTERNOON

Water laps against the bow of a FERRY. We WIDEN to find the boat making the short trip across the river from ALGIERS to NEW ORLEANS. A handful of passengers onboard.

We see Jackson Square and the peaks of the St. Louis Cathedral in the distance, they wave, beckon.

On the outdoor deck, taking in the view we find LAUREL, 20's-30's, freelance writer, familiar feeling, witful, fad-free fashion, classics. A regular commuter.

She's zoning out, absent-mindedly whistling Professor Longhair's "*Big Chief*"...

EXT. THE FLY - LATER

Picnic blankets line the greenway along the Mississippi River. People nap, eat, drink, as the sun slowly dips.

We're close on a RADIO. A hand finds the dial, flips it on, and we're consumed by a Cumbia tune. Los Guiros' "*Corazon Pesado*" bangs in and we're off on a tour of New Orleans as the promise of a Friday night fast approaches.

We will drop in on these folks throughout the night

-A GROUP OF FRIENDS, 30's, smoke on the balcony of an apartment. Inside, they get ready for the night. There's a mess of CLOWN MAKEUP AND CLOWN CLOTHES.

-SATURN BAR BARTENDERS, 30's-50's, tend to the wells of a much-loved neighborhood spot for drinks, dancing, parties. The rest of the venue prepares for a show. Sets up a PA.

-A PRIVATE CHEF/DJ, BENNY POPPINS, 40's, airpods in, preps food in a modern b&b. He's cooking for a large group of GUESTS, 20's-50's, who drink and commune in the background. He checks his apple watch as he slices produce.

-A BAND, 20's-40's, drives along the highway in their sprinter. Among them we find JIMMY, 30's, high-mileage life, reserved, same simple fashion he's sported forever, scrolling through his phone.

-Laurel exits the ferry.

-AT A TACO SHOP, a YOUNG RIPPING COUPLE, 20's, eats dinner peacefully, empty shot glasses and beers on the table.

-A COUPLE, 60's-80's, sits on the porch of their St. Charles home, taking in the evening, action on the avenue.

One of them turns the radio up. The streetcar passes, on it we find Laurel, heading uptown.

-At WWOZ fm, "*broadcasting live above Jax Brewery overlooking the Mississippi...*" we find ourselves in the radio station, the band playing the song live in-studio.

EXT. THE FLY - EARLY EVENING

We zero in on a GROUP OF FRIENDS, 20's-40's, splayed across blankets, taking in the scenery, radio on in the background.

Laurel approaches with a bottle of wine under her arm.

KAT
Right on time.

LAUREL
On time. In time. Good time.

CHELSEA
Always out to prove a point--

LAUREL
Public transportation is efficient
and if we don't use it, it will go
away.

KAT
Takes so long.

LAUREL
I work it in to my intentionally
flexible schedule.

She acknowledges the scenery, opens the bottle of wine--

LAUREL (CONT'D)
Why rush.

The cork pops out, accentuating her point.

RADIO
*Time for WWOZ's livewire---Tonight
at 21st Amendment.....*

NIC, 30's, the only man among the group, won't shut up about his days in Berlin and the art/rave scene--

NIC
Turn it up--turn it up---

CHELSEA
We've heard it ten times--

NIC
At least once more, please sir--

RADIO
*1am. Midnight Mass at Hotel Peter
and Paul...*

The group claps, snaps, Chelsea blushes--

LAUREL
Ten times and she's still blushing.

CHELSEA
If only they knew what a sick
sadistic performance they were
promoting.

KAT, 20's, new to the group, as if these other witches have
taken her under--

KAT
1am--or Midnight--?

CHELSEA
Midnight Mass at 1am. We fucked up
the time but are leaning into it.

RADIO
The Troubles at Toulouse at 7pm--

LAUREL
Hold on--who--what was that--

KAT
The Troubles. Sounds like a bad
punk band.

LAUREL
I think--Wait.

NIC
You know them?

Laurel pulls out her phone--

LAUREL
That's this guy I've been talking
to--

CHELSEA
App guy?

LAUREL

One of them. Some app gals in there, too.

NIC

Oh god, a tourist?

LAUREL

Musician. Doesn't count.

KAT

Musician? Again?!

NIC

Masochist.

LAUREL

Optimist. Non-generalist.

CHELSEA

How new are we? No tourists, no touring musicians, no transient ass! Locals only.

LAUREL

I've dated all the locals.

NIC

True.

LAUREL

Yeah, look (reads)--*"Nice to meet you virtually, Laurel, my band is playing Friday night, but would love to get a drink or something at some point."*

CHELSEA

Something at some point. No conviction.

KAT

Lacks specificity. Not great.

LAUREL

Who are The Troubles?

Nic pulls out his phone--

NIC

Is this him? Jimmy? Irish Jimmy?

LAUREL

I can't perceive an accent via the chat. But looks like him.

NIC

I remember this guy. He had a hit like ten years ago. How old is he?

LAUREL

Says thirty-four. Great. Just what the doctor ordered. Touring musician looking for a twenty-year-old Tulane chick. No offense, Kat.

KAT

I go to Loyola.

They laugh. Laurel tosses her phone down.

INT. SPRINTER - SAME

A large black van, high ceilings. There's ample space above the seats for cargo, instruments, etc. It pulls a small trailer with additional gear. The band is littered throughout.

Jimmy scrolls through his phone--

JIMMY

Laurel. Should I invite her to the show? Laurel. Huh.

His band chirps in from various nooks of the sprinter. PENNY, 30's, Jimmy's sister and bandmate, bisexual, can win the favor of any room she enters--

PENNY

No.

DARREN, 30's, anxious, American--

DARREN

Definitely not.

The third member, ZACH, 30's, American, doesn't say much, seems like he just goes in whatever direction he's pointed, sleeps against the window.

There's a Tour Manager, ANDREW, 30's-40's, sitting in the passenger seat, and a career Tour Driver, CARL, 50's-60's, behind the wheel.

DARREN (CONT'D)
Meet up with her after.

PENNY
Who knows, love of your life could already be in the audience. Front row. But if you already committed to this gal--

JIMMY
I can't think like that. Is that how your brain works?

PENNY
(shrugs)
Don't ask her to come watch you perform as a first date. Also, yeah, then you're really committing to an entire night with her.

JIMMY
Like it's such a terrifying idea. How am I supposed to commit to a lifetime if I can't commit to an entire night. Who are we? Is this dating now?

PENNY
Lifetime? Just go smooch someone you freak. We'll be in town for one night.

DARREN
It's not our fault we can't commit. Next best thing is a swipe away. It's irresistible.

JIMMY
This is how the machines beat us. A noncommittal species is a dead species. They've found our weakness and they're exploiting it with the promise of nonexistent better-ness around the corner.

DARREN
At least it's an optimistic ending. A promising one. Hopeful.

Jimmy laughs.

JIMMY
It's a cliff you walk off alone.

DARREN

With a bunch of smoking hot people
at the bottom waiting for you to
join the pile.

Jimmy laughs. Darren gets back to his phone. Penny gets up
and sits next to her brother--

PENNY

I think it's good for you. Just
going through the motions--the
exercise of it--help you get out of
your head a bit--

JIMMY

Yeah.

PENNY

Find your mojo again.

JIMMY

I'm nothing without my mojo.

PENNY

And I'm out of a gig without it.

Jimmy laughs.

PENNY (CONT'D)

Get rid of the picture of you in
the hat, though.

JIMMY

It's a good hat.

PENNY

It's really not.

Off Jimmy's laugh...

EXT. LOWER GARDEN DISTRICT RESTAURANT - LATER

Laurel and her friends eat and drink on an outdoor patio.

CHELSEA

Did he invite you to the show?

LAUREL

Wants to meet after for a drink.

KAT

Pass!

LAUREL
I don't want to go to his show--

CHELSEA
It's the principle!

NIC
He should've invited you.

LAUREL
I would've said no.

CHELSEA
It's the invite that counts. He
should invite you--and your hot
friends--so you could turn him down--
and pitch an alternative--

LAUREL
Maybe he's nervous.

NIC
He's not nervous. He wants to see
if there are any groupies he'd
rather hang out with.

LAUREL
You think? Are groupies still a
thing? Fuck this. I'm bailing.

CHELSEA
Good.

NIC
Don't bail. Get one drink out of
it. Harmless. If it sucks then
bail.

A SPRINTER hauls down Magazine Street--

INT./EXT. SPRINTER - CONTINUOUS

The band takes in the scenery outside the window--

DARREN
(to Tour Manager)
Did we get in at WWOZ for the in-
studio--

ANDREW
Too late notice, couldn't get a
slot.

DARREN
Shit. That would've been cool.

JIMMY
How are sales?

ANDREW
Almost sold out.

JIMMY
That's pretty good--

ANDREW
That's fucking great for New Orleans. Should have some walk-ups. Gutsy move coming down here. A lot of bands skip it entirely.

JIMMY
Why?

ANDREW
Hard city to pre-sell. So much great local music to compete with. Also, you can drink in public 24-hours a day. Not a great environment for touring bands. Or their crew--

Andrew shoots Carl, the driver, a knowing look. Carl catches it in his periphery. Keeps his eyes on the road.

ANDREW (CONT'D)
Ghosts. Vampires. Impossibly sexy loose people. A lot can go wrong in just the right way.

PENNY
Sounds like a perfect environment for me.

DARREN
An opium den is a perfect environment for you.

Off Penny's smile--

DARREN (CONT'D)
So is a beach with a tsunami approaching. I'd feel very safe with you.

PENNY
Thank you. I know.

TOUR MANAGER

I've seen some weird shit down here. I've also seen some of the most beautiful moments. It's a coin toss every time.

Off the band, taking in the scenery--

EXT. TOULOUSE THEATER - MOMENTS LATER

We're stationary, looking at the front of the venue, quiet before the storm. The General Manager, BRYANT, 30's-40's, opens the front door, moves a steel crowd barricade, kicks trash off the sidewalk into the street, away from the club.

The sprinter pulls up, parks. The members get out, stretch, light cigarettes.

BRYANT

Andrew?

Andrew reaches his hand out--

BRYANT (CONT'D)

Bryant. I'm the GM. Nice to meet you, thanks for coming down here--

ANDREW

Thanks for having us.

They all exchange hellos. Bryant props open a side tour--

BRYANT

You can load in through here. Alleyway goes straight back to the stage and green room.

The band peers down the long hallway. It's dark.

JIMMY

Looks haunted.

BRYANT

It is. Haunted as fuck. By the old owner of the place.

JIMMY

Really?

BRYANT

Yeah. Rio. He's around. He used to fuck around with Dylan, our bartender--she's been here for years--comes with the building--Rio used to lock her in the supply closet--for yucks--y'know? She'd do the same to him. Like siblings and shit. He passed away some years ago--every so often, she'll be here alone doing inventory and shit--she'll get locked in the supply closet.

DARREN

Come on...

PENNY

No way.

BRYANT

Hundred percent. She'll be in there alone and BAM! Door slams shut.

Off the band...

BRYANT (CONT'D)

I wouldn't believe it if I didn't have to come down her and let her out once a month. He's a nice ghost, though. Not all ghosts are scary. Some are actually pretty funny.

The band looks at each other, laughs.

BRYANT (CONT'D)

Let me know if you need anything. Hey--almost sold out. That's great. Should have some walk-ups.

Bryant goes inside, the band starts to load in.

INT./EXT. TOULOUSE THEATER - MOMENTS LATER

The band quietly unloads the gear down the long hallway.

We follow Jimmy back-and-forth a few times, from the sprinter to the stage, the audience fully along for the monotony of it. The slog. He seems weathered by it.

A glimpse of the road life we don't see and can't sensationalize because it's boring as fuck. The members pass each other silently, co-lift larger pieces of gear.

EXT. TOULOUSE THEATER - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy goes to the van--

DAD'S VOICE (O.C.)
Oh, little Liza...

KID'S VOICE (O.C.)
Little Liza Jane...

Jimmy looks up, spots a YOUNG COUPLE, 30's, with their DAUGHTER, 3, doing the call-and-response. The Dad and Jimmy acknowledge each other. They look vaguely similar, same age.

Jimmy takes in the family scene as they walk down the block.

MOM
What's your name, pretty little thing?

DAUGHTER
Little Liza Jane...

MOM
Where do you live, right down the lane?

Jimmy watches as they disappear around the corner--

DAUGHTER
Little Liza Jane...

He turns his attention back to the van, lugs an amp off it and heads back inside.

We stay static on the sprinter. Nobody around.

A KID ON A BMX BIKE, 19, cruises up, looks around, GRABS A ROAD CASE OFF THE SPRINTER. It's HEAVY, he can't carry it, he DROPS IT ON THE GROUND.

He reaches for ANOTHER SMALLER GUITAR CASE AND TAKES OFF.

Bryant SPOTS THIS THROUGH THE WINDOW OF THE VENUE AND DARTS AFTER THE GUY, he doesn't last long, the guy disappears. Jimmy comes out--

BRYANT
Some guy just lifted a guitar--

JIMMY
What?

Bryant is panting and coughing, trying to catch his breath--

BRYANT
You didn't have anyone watching
your shit--?

JIMMY
I--we should've--fuck. Where'd he
go?

BRYANT
Towards the park. Sorry. This is
the quarter, man. You gotta have
someone watching your shit---

Jimmy jogs down the block--comes back--

BRYANT (CONT'D)
He's gone, man. I went after him.
Fucker was fast.

JIMMY
We--we should've been out here.
Fuck.

BRYANT
Travel tax. Hope it wasn't a
special piece.

JIMMY
Yeah. I don't--

Jimmy looks at what's left in the sprinter, Darren comes out--

DARREN
What's up?

JIMMY
Someone took off with my baby
Taylor.

DARREN
Fuck, really?

JIMMY
Yeah--

DARREN
Shit. Sorry, man.

Jimmy exhales.

JIMMY
Travel tax.

Bryant is still panting, lights a cigarette.

BRYANT
Coulda been worse.

Bryant goes to the driver's side of the sprinter, opens the door, reaches in, takes the KEYS OUT of the ignition. He tosses them to Jimmy--

BRYANT (CONT'D)
I woulda taken the whole thing.

JIMMY
(to Darren)
Fucking Carl.

INT./EXT. PRESERVATION HALL - FRENCH QUARTER - LATER

Laurel and her friends approach Preservation Hall. They exchange pleasantries with the DOOR WOMAN, 20's-40's, and SECURITY GUARD, 30's-50's, as they head in--

SECURITY GUARD
Ay--Laurel--I read that shit in the Times-Picayune--When you going to write my biography?

LAUREL
We don't have an ending, Lucy--

SECURITY GUARD
I'm alive! That's the happiest ending, baby.

They hug, she enters--

INT. BACKSTAGE - LATER

The band sits around doing mostly nothing. Jimmy messes with a melody on a guitar--the band members casually give their feedback as he tries to figure it out--

JIMMY
*Was it all in my head/was any of it
real? Was it all in my head/How am
I supposed to feel? When you left
me for dead/now I knock on the door--*

ZACH
Eh...

DARREN
Sounds like a heaven's door thing--

Jimmy plays the chord again, changes the lyric--

JIMMY
*When you left me for dead/Now I sit
 on the floor--*

Penny joins in for the chorus--

JIMMY/PENNY
*Like a ghost, I am nothing/that I
 was before. Like a ghost I am
 nothing/that I was before--*

PENNY
 Almost needs more--like a choir--
 but not like--trendy folk pop trash-

JIMMY
 Yeah. Something. Maybe.

The TOILET LID SUDDENLY SLAMS SHUT AND IT FLUSHES.

They all trade looks--

DARREN
 Come on--

Darren gets up, inspects the bathroom--it's empty, the lid is shut--he grins. Zach raises an eyebrow.

PENNY
 You think he likes the song?

JIMMY
 I think he thinks it's shit.

Jimmy starts strumming harshly, egging on the spirit--

JIMMY (CONT'D)
*Like a ghost I am nothing/that I
 was before!*

Silence.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
 He agrees--needs a different vocal--

PENNY
 Maybe you'll summon something down
 here.

A FULL BEER SITTING ON THE TABLE SUDDENLY EXPLODES. They JUMP. SPOOKED. LAUGHING.

INT./EXT. PRESERVATION HALL - LATER

Laurel and Chelsea hang at the outdoor bar, a band plays on the outdoor stage. They drink and sort of watch casually, scanning the room--

LAUREL
I like getting older.

CHELSEA
Same.

LAUREL
I hated my twenties.

CHELSEA
Oh. I know.

LAUREL
I feel like I know stuff now.

CHELSEA
Exactly.

LAUREL
I was so worried in my twenties--

CHELSEA
What's that about--

LAUREL
What's everyone doing--what am I
doing--does anyone know I'm here--

CHELSEA
Universal. Feels so singular,
though--

LAUREL
My job--I got my ass kicked.

CHELSEA
Me, too--This young kid came in to
interview--brought his parents--

LAUREL
No way--

CHELSEA
Seriously.

LAUREL
To aging gracefully.

CHELSEA

I ain't fighting it. Some fucking cool old witches in this town and I can't wait to be one of them.

They cheers. They spot BEN JAFFE, ageless, Jewfro, tinted glasses for vibe correction, makes his way through the crowd, drumming up funding--

LAUREL

Here's Ben--

CHELSEA

Can you imagine growing up in the quarter?

LAUREL

He's like a cartoon character come to life. Tuba and everything.

INT. TOULOUSE THEATER - LATER

The Troubles are in the middle of their set. The crowd applauds, the lights dim, then ALL OF THEM COME UP. The entire house is lit.

Jimmy starts in on the a capella opening of "**Let it Burn**".

He mutters something to his band away from the mic, and the WHOLE BAND comes in with the chorus.

We see a much different side to Jimmy than the one we met earlier. He's a showman when he needs to be.

EXT. THE FRENCH QUARTER - LATER

Laurel exits Preservation Hall with her friends--

LAUREL

Okay, I'll ditch this ding-dong and come meet ya'll--

CHELSEA

If he's cool, bring him--bring his friends--

LAUREL

What if he sucks--

CHELSEA

Let's see if his show's done--

NIC
How convenient.

They head down the block and around the corner...

EXT. TOULOUSE THEATER - LATER

Jimmy exits the theater. A few fans stop him, say hi, he takes a photo, walks around the block. Lights a cigarette. Tries to get some space from the venue.

Things slow down as he watches the town pass by. He takes in the tourists. Kids on the prowl. Wedding parties.

He takes his phone out, starts scrolling through his app--

LAUREL (O.C.)
(mocking his inner-monologue)
I wonder if she's still down for that drink.

He looks up, Laurel and her friends are approaching, he checks his phone, her profile on his screen--

JIMMY
Huh. Look at that--

LAUREL
Hey sailor--

JIMMY
Laurel B. Is this advanced technology? A summon feature?

He holds his phone next to her face--

JIMMY (CONT'D)
You're prettier in person--

CHELSEA
Oh, boooo--

LAUREL
And from the big book of app date lines!

Nic laughs--

CHELSEA (CONT'D)
What are you doing outside?

LAUREL
These are my friends--

JIMMY

Will they be joining us?

KAT

Why are you--like--alone?

CHELSEA

How was the show?

LAURET,

Yeah, how'd it go?

JTMMY

Yeah--good, good crowd--

CHELSEA

Why didn't you invite her?

NIC

You didn't invite her?

JIMMY

I--

CHELSEA

You ask her out but you don't
invite her to the show? Are you
embarrassed? Do you get nervous? Is
it bad music?

KAT

Oh my god, you play bad music!

NTC

He was holding out for groupies.

He struggles to absorb it all--

CHELSEA

You were holding out for groupies!
Where are the groupies? Do you
think she's a groupie? I don't see
any groupies.

LAUREL

For the record, I've only ever been
a Band-Aid--

NTC

It's all happening...

CHELSEA

Where's the rest of your band--are they cute? Maybe she should hold out for another member of your band--

LAUREL

He looks harmless. Cuter than his app, pic, too--who picked those shitty pictures?

JIMMY

Penny. My sister.

KAT

I like men with sisters.

LAUREL

Same.

CHELSEA

Can we leave you with him? Do you feel safe?

NIC

I don't know if it's safe.

LAUREL

I think it's safe. You have my location.

NIC

Don't waste the whole night on a bad date--

JIMMY

Jesus--fucking peanut gallery--

LAUREL

We'll take it one location at a time. Is now good for you or do you have to like--shower?

KAT

He looks pretty sweaty.

JIMMY

There's a shower in the green room-- can I meet you somewhere around here in twenty minutes or so?

Laurel checks in with her friends--

LAUREL

We'll be at Manolito--

CHELSEA

Come meet her when you're good and ready.

JIMMY

Where--

CHELSEA

Dumaine and Decatur.

JIMMY

Right. Alright. Monolito--

LAUREL

Manolito--

JIMMY

Dumaine and Decatur.

They walk off, he watches. She turns, flashes him a smile. He returns it.

INT./EXT. TOULOUSE BALCONY - LATER

Jimmy walks through the second floor of the venue, drying off his hair, he exits onto a balcony overlooking the front of the venue--where his band and Bryant hang post-show.

They watch PEOPLE DOING NITROUS BALLOONS on the sidewalk across the street below--

BRYANT

He's here every night. People funnel right out to him. Guy makes a killing.

ZACH

Looks like a kid's birthday party.

BRYANT

I should get a cut of his haul. Or I should just employ him.

DARREN

Is that Carl?

ANGLE ON: Their driver, Carl, inhaling a balloon.

ANDREW

Motherfucker.

Andrew goes downstairs.

JIMMY

I'm gunna meet up with this girl--

PENNY

For real?

JIMMY

Yeah--just saw her--

DARREN

Saw her, what do you mean you saw her--

JIMMY

I was outside and she walked by with some friends--

PENNY

Friends? Hot friends?

JIMMY

Yeah.

PENNY

Nice. Gay friends?

JIMMY

Maybe the guy. Gunna grab a drink with her--I'll meet you at the hotel later--

ZACH

Cool.

DARREN

Don't get stolen--this town seems spooky--seriously--don't take any weird drugs or hang out with strangers--

JIMMY

Right. Because I got into the music business to avoid weird drugs and strangers.

PENNY

We have your location.

DARREN

Just. Don't snort anything.

BRYANT

Ubers have narcan.

JIMMY

Psychedelics only.

BRYANT
Take a roadie.

Bryant pours him a drink. Jimmy takes it.

BRYANT (CONT'D)
Great show, man. Give me a shout if
you need anything. You guys are
welcome back anytime.

Jimmy goes back through the balcony window, through Bryant's office, it's a mess of posters, wristbands, laptops, liquor. There's a radio playing WWOZ, we hold on it as Jimmy exits.

INT. WWOZ FM - CONTINUOUS

A DJ, 40's, peruses his playlist, leans into the mic--

DJ
Gunna shift the vibe a bit as we
officially enter Friday night.
Here's one from Big Freedia...

Big Freedia's "Revival" comes in, as it's cued we SMASH to...

EXT. FRENCH QUARTER - CONTINUOUS

-Jimmy walks past a CARAVAN OF THREE-WHEELED MOTORCYCLES (Slingshots), lit up like Christmas trees. Blasting the song. The tune takes us through the city as night has arrived...

-THE ST. CHARLES COUPLE pours another round, watches the action on the avenue, college kids, bachelorette parties...

-The YOUNG RIPPING COUPLE have a few drinks at a local bar.

-Jimmy walks through town, enjoying the spectacle. He watches people impromptu pole dance on 200-year-old french quarter balcony supports--

EXT. MANOLITO - MOMENTS LATER

Jimmy tosses his roadie in a trashcan as he approaches a small cuban joint, enters...

INT. MANOLITO - MOMENTS LATER

Jimmy walks through the restaurant, passes the kitchen where we spot cuban food being fired--he exits onto the patio where Laurel sits alone, chats with someone standing near her table--

LAUREL

I'll see you Sunday for the show--

The person returns the pleasantries and walks off--

JIMMY

Hi--how's it going? More friends?

LAUREL

Old neighbor. Find the place okay?

JIMMY

Yeah. Cool spot--

SERVER, 20's-40's, approaches, sets a glass of water and a table setting down for him, fills the glass--

SERVER

Can I get you something to drink?

Jimmy looks at her drink--

JIMMY

What's that?

LAUREL

Hemingway Daiquiri. It's good,
bartender's drink--

JIMMY

I'll do one of those, thank you.

Server is off--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Where'd your fun friends go?

LAUREL

They had to go set up for a show--

JIMMY

Musicians?

LAUREL

They do this experimental art
church thing. It's cool. Don't
worry, it's just me here--no one
else to gang up on you--

JIMMY

I can handle it--

LAUREL

Didn't seem like it.

JIMMY

Yeah, I couldn't at all--bunch of cool locals laying into me like that--fucking harsh, wasn't it--

LAUREL

Had to kick the tires a bit--

JIMMY

Musician you met online blowing through town. I don't blame you.

LAUREL

You do this a lot? App dates on tour? What's the point if you're just passing through--

JIMMY

Good question--I don't know--a way to pass the time in the van--

LAUREL

Oh. Fun! I'll just fuck off then-- actually you can fuck off--

JIMMY

Sorry--I meant--not like--

LAUREL

I get it. Play with the hearts and minds of stationary lonely souls so you can make the trip in your band van go by faster--

JIMMY

It's actually a sprinter--

LAUREL

Oh. A sprinter. The touring band mode of transportation between the creepy white van and the tour bus.

JIMMY

Right. Exactly. I don't know. Sorry, I actually have never done this. My sister just signed me up-- We live in a fast shrinking world, relationships can manage distance--

LAUREL

Not in my experience. Your first what--app date?

JIMMY

Yeah. I mean, in a while--had a few years ago--

LAUREL

Where were you last night--

JIMMY

Houston.

LAUREL

Why'd your location show New Orleans?

JIMMY

My sister set it there--

LAUREL

Oh shit, so you can match in advance before you get there--

JIMMY

I guess. Had no clue that was even possible.

LAUREL

She's a pro.

JIMMY

She's a goddamn Jedi when it comes to this shit.

Server approaches--puts his drink down. Him and Laurel clink.

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Cheers.

LAUREL

Cheers.

SERVER

Food?

Jimmy looks to her for a cue, she takes a beat, sort of glares at him, knowing the weight of such a decision.

LAUREL

Well, hey. Don't threaten me with a good time.

He laughs.

LAUREL (CONT'D)

(to Jimmy)

You hungry?

JIMMY

Yeah. You?

LAUREL

Anything you want specifically?

JIMMY

Whatever's good--

LAUREL

(to Server)

Can we do the cuban, smoked hummus,
and fritters, please--

Server takes the order down. The drums of *Charmaine Neville Band's "Iko Iko"* bust in.

INT. KITCHEN - MOMENTS LATER

WWOZ plays on the radio that sits above the prep station.

The small kitchen butts up against the bar. A box of vibrant produce sits between the kitchen and bar.

We watch the chefs assemble the entire meal through the duration of the song. Their conversation is slow as they cook. There are beats and jumps in time between, but it's the same conversation.

Ticket comes in.

CHEF 1

Annie is already dating.

CHEF 2

What? Really? Who?

CHEF 1

I don't know--Some guy named
Jeramie.

Ingredients come out.

CHEF 2

How do you know--

CHEF 1

Her Venmo.

CHEF 2

What?

CHEF 1
I looked at her Venmo. There he
was. Jeramie.

Chef 1 shrugs.

CHEF 2
Are you--what's wrong with you--

CHEF 1
I don't use social media.

CHEF 2
So you use Venmo. To keep track of
your exes.

CHEF 1
It's there--on my phone--I guess I
do search for her...

Smoked feta hummus is whipped, fritters are fried.

CHEF 1 (CONT'D)
What the fuck kind of name is
Jeramie? With an A and an *I-E*---

Chef 2 laughs.

CHEF 1 (CONT'D)
And what is she paying him for? I
don't really believe the pizza
emoji. Or maybe they got pizza.

CHEF 2
She paid him? Why would that make
you think it's a date? If she paid
him?

CHEF 1
That's her thing. She used to let
me pay, then I'd get home and she'd
Venmo me. Then we'd send it back-
and-forth--that was our thing. But
now she's doing that with him--

A cuban sandwich get assembled, pressed.

CHEF 2
She sent it publicly?

CHEF 1
Publicly.

CHEF 2
And you?

CHEF 1
Private. Always privately.

Beat.

CHEF 1 (CONT'D)
So I sent him twenty-four bucks.

Beat.

CHEF 2
What?

Beat.

CHEF 1
Yeah. Sent him twenty-four bucks.
Publicly.

CHEF 2
Why?

CHEF 1
So he knows. So she knows.

Beat.

CHEF 2
No--Wait, what? Why'd you Venmo the
guy twenty-four bucks?

CHEF 1
So they know!

CHEF 2
Know what?

CHEF 1
That I know!

CHEF 2
Do you know this guy?

CHEF 1
Never met him in my life--

CHEF 2
And you sent him twenty-four bucks
out of nowhere--

CHEF 1
Yeah. So now everyone knows.

CHEF 2
Knows *what*?!

CHEF 1
That I fucking know! They're together!

Chef 2 cracks up. Shakes his head.

CHEF 2
Why twenty-four dollars?

CHEF 1
(shrugs)
Price of a pizza. Ballpark.

The food is plated. Server takes it out, we follow it out to Laurel and Jimmy...

EXT. PATIO - CONTINUOUS

The food lands on their table--

LAUREL
Come on--

JIMMY
I truly--did not think that far ahead--Selfishly, admittedly--I'd rather experience a town with someone I don't know, who can show me something about the town I'm in--than my fucking band I spend every minute with. Not that I don't love them--but--it's not glamorous. At all. We'd be standing around some sticky table at a pub with huge bright TV's, eating much worse food, until we all get much drunker than we want--or should--Penny kisses some bartender or *hits* some bartender--We get bad sleep, wake up, and run it again from the top.

Off Laurel--

JIMMY (CONT'D)
Sometimes we change the set list.

LAUREL
I'm not a tour guide.

JIMMY
You're going to want to show off
your town, though, right? You don't
want a bumner of a Friday night.
You want to show a stranger the
cool shit--

Server approaches, refills their water--

JIMMY (CONT'D)
--You don't want me to leave New
Orleans thinking it's overrated--

Server overhears this--

SERVER
Do you want me to kick him out?

Jimmy smiles--

LAUREL
(to Server) Maybe. We'll see. Thank
you. (to Jimmy) Say that again. A
sinkhole will open up and you'll
disappear forever.

He laughs.

LAUREL (CONT'D)
True, though. But if you can't have
a good time here, you're the
problem.

JIMMY
Have your Friday night, let me tag
along, the second I get boring let
me know and I'll leave.

LAUREL
Simple enough.

JIMMY
I just got out of a marriage.

Laurel nearly spits her drink out. She cracks up. He smiles.

LAUREL
What!

JIMMY

Well, technically we're still married, but split.

LAUREL

Amicably?

JIMMY

We don't talk. So. Yeah. Amicably. Silently amicably.

LAUREL

Touring married musician. Actually, you being this awful of a prospect takes the pressure off.

JIMMY

I'm glad you feel that way. Less pressure will make this more fun.

LAUREL

What happened?

JIMMY

Huh?

LAUREL

With your ex--

JIMMY

We lost our daughter.

LAUREL

What?

Laurel just stares at him.

JIMMY

Doctor said it was unexplained natural causes. I don't know what that even means. Sudden infant death. Marriage never really bounced back.

LAUREL

How old--

JIMMY

Barely two-years.

Server approaches--

SERVER

Another round?

LAUREL
Check, please.

Jimmy gives a look that he's not exactly surprised--

LAUREL (CONT'D)
Oh my god, I'm kidding!

He smiles. Blushes. Shrugs.

JIMMY
I wouldn't have been offended--

LAUREL
Please, yes--another round--
actually--can we do--(to him) Mind
if I take some liberties here?

JIMMY
Play the hits--

LAUREL
Two Miami Vices, please--

He looks at her--

JIMMY
What's in that--

LAUREL
Sunshine and rum.

BEAT.

LAUREL (CONT'D)
Christ, I'm sorry. That's fucking
hard.

JIMMY
What about you--lot of app dating?

LAUREL
Some. It's always there, I guess. I
don't know. Just got out of a long
thing with this one dude. I go on
lots of singles cruises.

JIMMY
What? Really?

LAUREL
No, dude.

He laughs.

JIMMY

Sounds fun.

LAUREL

Sorta does, huh? I don't know,
feels like a video game I don't
want to play. On the phone.

JIMMY

The phones. Exactly.

LAUREL

Weird game.

JIMMY

Is this a cool town for old kids
like us? What's the scene here--our
age--your age--

LAUREL

Good for any age. Doesn't matter
what age. I hang out with eighty-
year-olds and twenty-year-olds.
They're all up at the bar. Nobody
wants to grow up here because you
don't really have to. It's
Disneyland for adults.
Coincidentally--Disney took a lot
of inspiration from this town.

The Server comes out with two frosty tall blended drinks, a
swirl of pink and white.

JIMMY

Speaking of Disney--

LAUREL

Buckle up.

JIMMY

Aren't these tourist drinks?

LAUREL

Out on Bourbon Street. Not here.
All fresh produce, top shelf booze.

JIMMY

What is it?

LAUREL

It's a Pina Colada and a Strawberry
Daiquiri mixed together.

He takes a sip.

JIMMY

Damn. That's good. Wow.

He goes back in.

LAUREL

I'll take you to see some cool shit-

JIMMY

Don't do it out of pity--

LAUREL

No--no--I was giving you a hard time. I know what I signed up for. But, again, I'm not going to be your tour guide. You and your band can go to Café du Monde and Congo Square on your own time--

JIMMY

For sure. The donuts.

LAUREL

Beignets.

JIMMY

And Congo Square...the--

She waits for him to finish. He doesn't. She hangs her head.

LAUREL

Fucking shit. (shouts O.C.) Konrad!
Can we get some go-cups, please!

A server approaches with two plastic cups and the e-terminal for the bill. Jimmy pays, Laurel dumps their drinks in the plastic cups, they do it in silence. They look like they've been doing this for years.

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Thank you, very kind of you.

JIMMY

You weren't going to offer.

LAUREL

Fuck no.

They laugh. They get up and take off. We stay on their table as the server clears the dishes. Wipes the table down. Puts down new place settings.

We hold on the table. A MAN, 30's, and a WOMAN, 30's, sit down moments later.

MAN

Nice to finally meet you in person

WOMAN

Ya....

Man goes to take off his jacket and KNOCKS OVER THE CARAFE OF WATER. It shatters on the ground.

MAN

Oh, fuck--

The guy starts to pick up the glass with his hands, the woman looks around the restaurant...

EXT. FRENCH QUARTER/ROYAL STREET - LATER

Jimmy and Laurel are walking through a busy, but not insane part of the French Quarter. As they walk we hear an acoustic song playing faintly in the background, it gets louder.

A look falls over Jimmy's face. Confused.

They spot a BUSKER, 20's, playing to a small crowd on Royal Street. Jimmy looks briefly, then keeps walking, tries to take a different street--

LAUREL

Have you these in the old country?

JIMMY

I think we invented the idea of singing for money on the street.

Laurel stops to watch. Jimmy continues to walk--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Let's--

LAUREL

Hold on--

Jimmy watches from a distance as the guy plays guitar.

He's playing "**5150**". Jimmy looks around. He almost looks concerned. The guy's voice bounces off the cobblestone.

He finishes the song. They continue their walk, past the busker-- Jimmy pulls his wallet out. A few people toss bills in the guitar case. Busker mutters a thank you here and there. Jimmy quickly drops the bill in, Busker looks up--

BUSKER

Oh, shit--

Jimmy smiles.

JIMMY

Nice one, man--

Busker is flushed.

BUSKER

Fuck, that's fucking embarrassing.

JIMMY

That was great.

LAUREL

You guys know each other?

JIMMY

Jimmy--

He reaches his hand out, they shake--

BUSKER

Patrick.

JIMMY

Sounds better on you.

BUSKER

Thanks, man. How was the show?

JIMMY

Yeah, good. Good crowd.

BUSKER

I'll catch it next time.

JIMMY

Have a good one, man.

BUSKER

You, too.

Jimmy and Laurel walk off.

LAUREL

What was that?

Jimmy turns, makes sure they're out of an earshot--

JIMMY

What?

LAUREL
You know him?

JIMMY
I thought you did--

LAUREL
What?

JIMMY
Why'd we stop to watch--

LAUREL
I wanted to check it out--

JIMMY
Oh--

LAUREL
You didn't know him? How'd he know
you were in town--

JIMMY
I think he just meant--He was
playing an old song of mine--

LAUREL
No way. You paid that guy to do
that.

JIMMY
I mean, yeah--technically--

LAUREL
No, before--was that a plant--?
Holy shit! A busker plant--woah,
that's a well-oiled machine, huh?
The tour date. Who puts him there,
your manager?

JIMMY
Great idea--I'll use that on the
next stop--Jackson, I think.

She laughs.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
That's never happened to me before.
I can pretend to be cool like that
happens--but--never. No one knows
my stuff. Haven't heard that one
played back to me ever--

LAUREL

That shit in the song actually
happen or you like do a--Tom Waits
thing--Elliott Smith narrator thing--

JIMMY

My sister 51-50'd me after--after
my daughter and then--some drunk
driving. Irish guy wasted on the
Pacific Coast Highway. 72-hour
lockup. I'm good now, though. I
think it was a tad excessive,
she'll tell you a different story.

LAUREL

Great way to expedite a date--gimme
all the shit--

JIMMY

You've got nearly all of it by now,
really. You? What about you--Dirt.

LAUREL

Oh. So much. But I don't fucking
know you--

JIMMY

What! I'm telling you everything.

LAUREL

That's on you, dude.

She smiles, shrugs. He laughs.

EXT. ARMSTRONG PARK - LATER

They approach Congo Square. We stay in a wide as they're
framed by an illuminated ARMSTRONG PARK sign.

LAUREL

I can't manage one more musician
blowing through this town without
paying their respects--

Jimmy looks at a RED PLAQUE, shines his phone light on it--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

I can recite that whole thing but what you need to know is that in the late 1740's, to early 1800's-- Almost in this exact location, jazz, R & B, rock and roll, hip-hop, goddamn American music was invented right here. Decades, centuries, of music that influenced everyone that made it all the way to your little twelve-year-old ears in Dublin--

JIMMY

--Belfast--

LAUREL

Belfast--to inspire you to pick up an instrument. Improvised music. Motherfucking jazz. The birth of cool as we know it. You wouldn't be here, if they weren't *here*.

Jimmy takes in the surroundings.

JIMMY

This is why I do this--I wouldn't have had this experience on my own. I had to find some cool woman on an app to mansplain the history of jazz to me.

LAUREL

You're welcome!

She walks off, he follows--

JIMMY

Seriously, though, I'm glad I came here--thank you--

LAUREL

Right? Wouldn't you have been bummed? To learn afterward--you're in a hotel in England or some shit, some news thing comes on about this place, you realize you were down the street but didn't come check it out--

JIMMY

Absolutely. Is this one of those tours with the cars that turns into a boat?

LAUREL
Shut up, smartass--

They laugh, walk off--

EXT. FRENCH QUARTER - LATER

We're in a static wide as they walk toward camera. They're far in the distance. We stay in the same shot--

LAUREL
I pull into the gas station--walk into the store--going to pee my pants--my hat is down--I'm wearing baggy-boy clothes--I don't want to attract attention--trying not to be seen as a single woman alone on a road trip in the middle of fucking nowhere--I hear yelling, shouting and this dude RUNS into me, like--SLAMS. He falls down. Trips, goes to the ground. Register of cash goes FLYING--clerk comes out--holding a fucking shotgun--tackles the fucking guy--

JIMMY
Are you kidding?

LAUREL
Didn't even see him coming and I stopped him. Guess he didn't see me, either--my disguise worked.

JIMMY
You're a hero.

LAUREL
I am. I really am. Yeah. That's when I got a crazy excited teenager on the loose feeling...only I was twenty-five. About twenty hour drive--Manhattan to here. Alone. Beautiful but a little scary. Two days. Gorgeous country out there. The second I got here I felt like it was a hug--like I got here just in time for the party. Very welcoming place and people.

A COUPLE CLOWNS dart past. Jimmy takes note, Laurel doesn't.

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Hard to eject from the hamster wheel, though--the community I have in New York, it's so strong. When I'm back there--it's just--my entire life--everyone I grew up with, school, parents, siblings, cousins, step-siblings--when are you getting married, when are you having kids, what's your plan--here it's...what's up tonight? Who's playing?

Jimmy laughs. A COUPLE MORE CLOWNS run past, one of them honks a horn--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

I'm on a bit of a different trajectory. Try to limit things that prevent me from taking random jobs, traveling whenever--

JIMMY

No kids, no dog--

LAUREL

No kids. No dog. Couple cats, but they're self-sufficient. They feed me half the time. I see some friends back home--

THE YOUNG RIPPING DUDE, runs past them--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

--They're dead behind the eyes now. They tapped out. It sucks.

As he runs he DUCKS BEHIND JIMMY and JIMMY IS NAILED with a FROZEN PURPLE DRINK. It EXPLODES off his chest--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Oh, shit!

JIMMY

Wow. Fuck--

Laurel cracks up. Jimmy is more surprised than angry--he laughs. THE YOUNG RIPPING WOMAN goes RUNNING past--

WOMAN

MOTHERFUCKER GET BACK HERE!

She's shouting at her boyfriend, bolting down the street-- Woman chases after him, blows past Jimmy--

WOMAN (CONT'D)

Sorry, dude--!

She runs off. Camera stays on Jimmy and Laurel--

LAUREL

Oh, boy--

She looks at the styrofoam cup on the ground--

JIMMY

What is it--?

LAUREL

Lafitte's. Voodoo Drink.

He licks some off his arm.

JIMMY

Tastes like cough medicine.

LAUREL

No one knows what's in it. Shit
will fuck you up. Here--this place
has good merch--

Camera PANS and follows them to THE GOLDEN LANTERN, a few
people drink and smoke outside. They enter.

INT. THE GOLDEN LANTERN - CONTINUOUS

Square bar in the middle surrounded by stools, slot machines
to your right, karaoke stage and cigarette machine in the
room to the left. Laurel is a regular at this gay haunt--

LAUREL

What do you want?

JIMMY

Tequila.

LAUREL

Great. I'll buy you a shirt and
this round--but you have to play a
song--

JIMMY

What?

LAUREL

Just one--

JIMMY

Here?

Jimmy looks around. She gestures to a small stage area--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Oh. No. Thanks.

LAUREL

Don't be lame!

JIMMY

Lame! What? You play a song--

LAUREL

Too cool?

JIMMY

What?

LAUREL

Seriously.

JIMMY

I'll buy the shirt for myself!
Drinks on me.

LAUREL

Hey--I showed you some cool shit.
We've been on this date for less
than two hours and you're already a
whole different person.

JIMMY

True. I have changed--improved,
nonetheless--dramatically--over a
short period of time and it's all
thanks to you.

LAUREL

Thank you for acknowledging that.
You also didn't invite me to the
show--

JIMMY

Would you have come?

LAUREL

Certainly not. But I'm worried I'll
hate your music. It doesn't benefit
either of us to continue this date
if I go home and look you up only
to find out it's shit music--

JIMMY
You're auditioning me?

LAUREL
Yes. Great way to put it. What's a date any way if not one stupid human audition?

He can't fault the logic.

LAUREL (CONT'D)
What, you want me to peel off into the bathroom and listen to your music on my phone? Or would you rather play it for me--that's the difference between how you play music--how the modern "*band*" plays music--and how this town does it--

JIMMY
What's the difference?

LAUREL
You're a precious little bitch.

JIMMY
No, I--Okay. Bitch? Whatever. I'm not a jukebox, you know--I'm also not a bitch either--

LAUREL
Little bitch.

JIMMY
I'm not a *little* bitch, either. Can you even say that?

LAUREL
I think you can say anything now again which is exciting. You're not a jukebox like I'm not a tour guide but hey--make sure you give me a good rating on the app. Sorry I called you a bitch.

JIMMY
There's ratings? On the dating apps?

LAUREL
What? No!

JIMMY
Oh. Woah. I don't know--damn.

LAUREL

I understand--it's your art, you get paid to perform-- However, as your tour guide, in your brief time here, I think it would behoove you greatly to get down with the general vibe and approach to music that this town practices.

JADE, 30's, bartender, approaches--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Hey Jade--

JADE

How's it, babygirl?

LAUREL

Great. How are you?

JADE

Working doubles. Apartment's flooding. I have two boyfriends and one girlfriend. None of them can fix the leak. I'm fantastic. What are you drinking--

LAUREL

Two tequila sodas and a Lantern Trash shirt.

Jade shoots Jimmy a look, sizes him up, Laurel does the same--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Large. Please and thank you.

Jimmy looks at the wall of merch. She chose the least gay option. The other two are sequence tank tops. He sheds his shirt. A few people holler, she looks him up-and-down. He puts the new shirt on.

LAUREL (CONT'D)

(to bartender)

Can we borrow the guitar ya'll got back there--?

Jade looks suspicious--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

He's just going to play one--he played Toulouse earlier tonight--he's no slouch.

Jade silently goes back, gets the guitar--

LAUREL (CONT'D)
I hope. We're about to find out.

Jade hands him the guitar--it's pink, bedazzled, looks like something from a Chappell Roan music video.

INT. STAGE AREA - MOMENTS LATER

It's more of a chair in front of a shoddy projection screen. He reluctantly sits with the guitar.

JIMMY
Alright--

He starts to play something. Stops.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
Eh.

LAUREL
Yeah. Play something finished. Play one I know.

JIMMY
One of mine?

LAUREL
Do I know any?

JIMMY
There's one you might know.

LAUREL
Really! Play that. Is this going to be like a thing? Like I realize I know some one-hit-wonder you wrote years ago--

He shoots her a look.

JIMMY
Perhaps. Hope not. Probably.

He exhales. Figures if he's going to do it...

Jimmy dives into "*Cecilia*". It's heartfelt. It becomes clear to Laurel that Cecilia is his daughter's name.

He finishes the song. A smattering of applause comes from the bar nearby, people weren't watching, but listening.

Laurel claps. A look falls across her face--

LAUREL

Oh my god. That's from that show--

A DRINKER, 50's, from the other side of the bar, hollers out without getting up, we angle on him--

DRINKER

What's that fucking show!

It clearly bothers them, they can't put their finger on it--

JIMMY

Shit. You knew that?

Drinker continues to shout at them, involving the entire room--

DRINKER (O.C.)

What's it called?! The kid's show!

LAUREL

That fucking teen show like ten years ago...

Laurel speaks to Jimmy but the Drinker keeps interjecting--

DRINKER

I'd come home and my daughter had that show on the Tivo--that song, man--shit--

JIMMY

It was called Cecilia, same as the song--

LAUREL

Yeah! The one about the high school girl--*Cecilia*--!

JIMMY

They couldn't afford Paul Simon's Cecilia. So they used mine. Now I can afford to eat.

Drinker didn't hear them land on the answer, but he's had a lightbulb moment in the other room--

DRINKER (O.C.)

Fucking Cecilia! THAT'S IT! (to Laurel) Hey! Hey! It's *Cecilia*!

LAUREL

(shouting)

Yup!

(MORE)

LAUREL (CONT'D)

(to Jimmy) It's about your daughter
but they used it as the theme song
to the teen beach show--

JIMMY

I think it was a lake. Or
waterfall. Some horny body of water--
but yeah--

They relocate to a high-top with their drinks. They sit in
silence for a moment. It's comfortable.

LAUREL

Unexplained natural causes, but--
when you found out--how--what
happened--also if you don't want to
talk about it or it's rude of me to
ask just tell me--

JIMMY

It's fine. Yeah. My sister called.
Said to get to the hospital. Said
it was Cecilia. I didn't know what
was going on. I didn't even ask--I
just drove as quickly as possible.
I don't remember much but the--

He stops--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

I turned the corner--the bed. The
hospital bed. It sort of occurred
to me in that moment--they don't
make hospital beds for infants. It
was a normal sized bed. I turn the
corner and I just saw her little
arm hanging off the bed.

This lands with Laurel. There's a beat of silence.

THE LOUD REV OF A HUGE ENGINE takes us JUST OUTSIDE where THE
THREE SLINGSHOTS ARE CARAVANNING, BLASTING BOUNCE MUSIC.

We cut from a medium of Jimmy and Laurel to a WIDE.

The slingshots are in the foreground, Jimmy and Laurel in the
background, we can't hear them over the Slingshots.

One of the Slingshots has broken down, we drop in on the
drivers--

DRIVER 1

Motherfucker--

DRIVER 2
Motherfucker I told you to fill up--

DRIVER 1
I did!

DRIVER 2
That half-ass shit you do--

Driver 1 revs his engine, sounds like it's stalling out. In the background Jimmy and Laurel continue their conversation. We watch from a distance. The bounce track continues, DRIVER 1 turns the radio up--

INT. WWOZ FM - CONTINUOUS

The song takes us inside the studio. The DJ that brought us into the movie is packing up a backpack. TWO DJ'S, 30's-40's, walk in with boxes of 45's, they exchange pleasantries as they change shifts.

The bounce track fades out--DJ leans into the microphone--

DJ
That's it for me tonight, thanks
ya'll. Eddie and Derrick just
showed up to play you some
meticulously selected 45's--

Derrick drops the needle on the turntable--The Dixie Cups'
"I'm Gunna Get You Yet" comes in...

EXT. THE GOLDEN LANTERN - CONTINUOUS

In the same shot of the Slingshots in the foreground, Jimmy and Laurel continue to talk. We slowly push in on them. A COUPLE starts to slowly dance to the song outside the bar.

A CLOWN runs by.

A SMALL PARTY walks by, holding drinks, smoking, stumbling--

PARTIER
Oh--fuck! That's our song! Turn
that shit up!

DRIVER 1
What!

PARTIER
Turn it up!

Driver 1 turns it up, we continue to push in, the group passing busts into a synchronized parade-walk step.

Singing, fucking up the steps, but it's good.

As the action continues in the foreground, we continue to push in until we land back on Jimmy and Laurel--

JIMMY

What would you have done if you hated it?

LAUREL

Said I was tired and gone home or left completely unannounced--

JIMMY

Right.

LAUREL

Would've just run out of here.

JIMMY

Understandable.

His attention is stolen as MORE CLOWNS DASH PAST the bar, he watches them flail down the street--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

I knew New Orleans had vampires and ghosts, but what's with all the fucking clowns? Is there a clown thing here, too? Clown convention?

LAUREL

Oh, fuck! The clowns!

She watches them run down the street--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

You like clowns?

JIMMY

Can't stand them.

LAUREL

Really?

JIMMY

Fucking terrified.

LAUREL

These are different.

JIMMY
You like clowns?

LAUREL
Sure. I like 'em fine. You like LCD
Soundsystem?

JIMMY
Almost less than I like clowns.

LAUREL
No shit! Me, too. So overrated.

JIMMY
Wow. What a relief you agree.

LAUREL
But this is different. It's a cover
band. Only instance in the history
of cover bands where I like the
cover band more than the band.
Because they're all clowns.

JIMMY
The band?

LAUREL
The band. The audience. The
lighting person. Front of house.
Back of house. Everyone in the
room. Clowns everywhere. Wall-to-
wall clowns.

JIMMY
Clowns playing LCD Soundsystem
sounds like my nightmare.

LAUREL
Want to check it out?

JIMMY
Absolutely.

EXT. SATURN BAR - LATER

The venue sits on the corner, it's swarmed by a crowd of
CLOWNS. Laurel and Jimmy approach the herd.

Jimmy and Laurel get in line, the only ones not in
makeup/clown gear. As they cue up, clowns contribute to their
look, someone gives them some makeup, a nose, a neckerchief,
a hat... Laurel is doing his makeup--

JIMMY
Is this a big thing here?

LAUREL
It's kind of a new thing. But it's
like the old thing. Clowning,
masking, costumes, Mardi Gras.
Outside. Inside. Light. Dark. Two
sides of the coin thing, y'know?

JIMMY
Live the question. Sure. Duality.

LAUREL
Duality. Sure. Who are you? Who's
your clown?

JIMMY
I don't know yet. Perhaps I should
have a hand in the doing of it
though, right? My own expression.

Laurel offers the makeup to him--

LAUREL
Oh--my--please. By all means. How
rude of me. I would love that.

Jimmy starts messily applying it. In general smears of
makeup. With no real plan or finesse.

JIMMY
How's it?

She takes it in. It's awful.

LAUREL
It's so bad, it's fascinating.

She holds a mirror up for him to see. He's terrifying. Rough
draft Joker. He laughs at how bad it is.

JIMMY
I love it.

LAUREL
What's his name?

JIMMY
Scruples.

She laughs.

LAUREL
Scruples!

He lights a cigarette. Takes a drag.

JIMMY
I'm Scruples the clown.

She puts on her makeup, has clearly done this before.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
And you?

LAUREL
Daphne. Tonight, I'm Daphne.

Their looks come together. As various clowns clear the METAL DETECTOR they pull all sorts of wild shit from their pockets-- a horn, a deck of cards, one clown PULLS A LONG COLORFUL RIBBON from his throat as he's going through.

LSD CLOWNSYSTEM'S "*ST. CLAUDE SORCERESS*" takes us to...

INT. SATURN BAR - CONTINUOUS

They enter, the place is wall-to-wall clowns. Jimmy can't believe it. They get in line for drinks. Laurel runs into some friends, they have an exchange. Laurel's friend pulls out a small bag of mushroom doses, Laurel takes the bag--

LAUREL
Don't threaten me with a good time.

She takes a few, gestures to Jimmy, he gives a "what the hell" shrug and throws a couple back.

INT. SATURN BAR - LATER

The show rages on, Jimmy takes in the room, the clowns, Laurel. People hang from the balcony. He's not tripping, but he's loose. They're dancing, after a couple verses--

They weave through the crowd, she approaches the Women's room, the door is wide open, she turns to enter--

LAUREL
Oh, fuck!

She covers her mouth, can't stop laughing, Jimmy is curious--

JIMMY
What?

He peers into the bathroom--sees a Woman leaning over the stall door (presumably) being gone down on...from behind.

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Oh, fuck--

He takes a closer look, can't tell through the clown makeup--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Penny?

The bathroom clown's eyes SHOOT OPEN--Laurel grabs his hand, shuts the door, pulls Jimmy into...

INT. MEN'S ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Guys are pissing in the trough, Jimmy and Laurel duck into the stall. Laurel squats, grabs his hand, laughing--

LAUREL

The number of women I've seen
getting eaten out in that bathroom--
incredible.

JIMMY

I think that was my sister!

LAUREL

What!

JIMMY

I couldn't tell--

LAUREL

No way--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Maybe I'm tripping.

Laurel finishes peeing, they switch spots, Jimmy pees--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Dude--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Jesus.

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Really?

JIMMY

She gets more ass than anyone on
tour--ruthless--wouldn't be
surprised--

Off Laurel's laugh we SMASH TO...

EXT. SATURN BAR - LATER

The show is winding down, clowns commune outside. Jimmy and Laurel make small talk. They slowly peel away from the crowd.

EXT. MARIGNY/BYWATER - LATER

They walk down the middle of the street. In silence. Smiles. Jimmy starts to wipe the clown makeup off with his shirt.

LAUREL
We can still make art church.

JIMMY
Can we wash this shit off?

LAUREL
Yeah. Up here--

INT./EXT. MARIGNY PORCH - MOMENTS LATER

They skip up a few stairs of a lively home. There's a dinner party happening inside--

LAUREL
Friendly neighborhood gays. I
housesit for them sometimes.

JIMMY
We can't go in there like this. I'm
on drugs. I think. I'm not sure
they kicked in yet. Do you feel
yours? Did you see all those
clowns?

LAUREL
Little bit. For all we know they're
dressed as clowns and also on
drugs.

She knocks. Nothing.

LAUREL (CONT'D)
But it's Friday so it's probably
just Shabbat--

JIMMY
Shabbat? Do I look okay?

She looks at him, smeared-ass clown makeup. He does not look okay. They crack up--

LAUREL
Not at all.

She opens the door, enters...

INT. MARIGNY HOME - CONTINUOUS

Well-decorated and designed. It's cozy. A beautiful piano with music out, actually gets used, sits in the living room.

Remnants of drinks and food around. A happy drunk voice bellows from inside--

VOICE (O.C.)
What the fuck?! Intruders!

They're both still in full clown makeup, they've arrived at the later hour of the Shabbat/dinner party when everyone is loose. The drunk part.

DIOGO (O.C.)
Clowns! Ew!

LAUREL
It's Laurel!

DIOGO, 40's, appears, a crowd of dinner guests seated casually at the table behind him, post-dessert, drinking--

DIOGO
It's Laurel! And a clown! Ew!

LAUREL
Shabbat Shalom.

MICHAEL, 30's-50's, the co-host, comes walking over--

MICHAEL
Shabbat Shalom, honey! Are you two hungry? We have so much food--

Jimmy smiles--takes in the room, the most eclectic Shabbat on the planet. All ages, backgrounds, cuisines...

LAUREL
No, we ate, thank you--

DIOGO
Have a drink with us--

MICHAEL
Who's this clown?

JIMMY
Jimmy--well, Scruples.

He reaches his hand out--

MICHAEL
Jimmy Scruples?

JIMMY
Why not.

MICHAEL
Come in, come in--

LAUREL
Can we use your bathroom to take
this makeup off?

MICHAEL
But you look so wonderful and
charming and doll-like...

To Jimmy--

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
And you look fucking absurd.
Nightmare. Total nightmare.

INT. BATHROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Jimmy and Laurel are in a fancy guest bathroom with vibrant alligator wallpaper. Laurel opens the medicine cabinet, it's all makeup and glitter. She grabs a pack of remover wipes.

Louis Armstrong's "*La Vie En Rose*" starts in from the other room, just piano and trumpet parts...

LAUREL
Bad news. You're probably going to
have to play--

JIMMY
I'm not going to follow Louis
Armstrong in New Orleans.

They listen through the door as she takes his makeup off--

INT. LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Michael plays piano. One of the guests plays the trumpet.

We pan across the faces of the guests as the tune leads up to the vocal, there are a few faces that look like they'd be the one to sing the Louis part.

A BIG BURLY DAD, 50's, opens his mouth, about to sing--the vocal comes in, it's not him.

We land on a YOUNG NON-BINARY KID, TRINITY, 17, they belt it out, this low raspy voice should not be coming from this teenager, it's perfect. Everyone is surprised, laughs.

INT. BATHROOM - CONTINUOUS

They fill the trash can up with tie-dyed remover wipes as the song continues. It's intimate. They look at each other, remnants of makeup still on their faces.

Jimmy runs the sink, splashes water on his face. He mindlessly takes a plush white towel and wipes his face off--

LAUREL

Dude!

He removes the towel--covered in colorful makeup.

JIMMY

Shit. Is that bad?

She laughs.

LAUREL

Scruples...

JIMMY

Shit. Fuck. Will this come out?

LAUREL

Yes, it's fine--don't worry--

JIMMY

Fuck. I fucked up.

She laughs at how concerned he is. He checks himself in the mirror, makes sure the makeup is off--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Scruples, no more--

She keeps wiping her face off.

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Thanks for showing me around.

She dabs the corner of his face, getting some makeup he missed. The song crescendoes...

JIMMY (CONT'D)
I'm having a really great time.

LAUREL
So am I.

She smiles, refreshed by his sincerity, continues to dab his makeup until she can't hold back and KISSES HIM. They pull each other in. Makeup wipe in her hand, pressed against the side of his head. She drops it.

They kiss intensely, barely keeping it under control. They separate. Collect themselves. Smile. Silent.

She laughs, opens the door, they exit--

LAUREL (CONT'D)
Scruples.

INT. LIVING ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

The song ends, they clap, cheer, raz the young vocalist. Laurel and Jimmy have joined.

TRINITY
Oh, shit--you're that guy from that band--Troubles--Johnny--

Laurel is surprised, the adults are less aware--

DIOGO
Band?!

TRINITY
Yeah, you played Toulouse tonight--my friends went--said it was cool--

JIMMY
Great. Yeah. That's me--well, it's Jimmy--actually--

TRINITY
I didn't recognize you with that disgusting clown makeup on.

JIMMY
Yeah. I did it myself.

TRINITY
No shit. Full sicko mode. Awful.

They laugh.

DIOGO
(to Jimmy)
What do you have for us?

JIMMY
Huh? Yeah, sorry--

Jimmy looks to Laurel for some social support, she'd rather see how he fares by himself--

JIMMY (CONT'D)
Last minute stop, we came empty handed--

DIOGO
I meant song--what do you have for us--

JIMMY
Oh. I don't really play the piano.

DIOGO
We have a guitar, harmonica, horns,
I think there's a ukulele somewhere--

JIMMY
I'm pretty beat--had a show earlier--

MICHAEL
Oh, he's beat from his show.

The guests crack up.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
Show!

Jimmy checks in with Laurel, she lets him fry--

DIOGO
Of course, how exhausting!

MICHAEL
My dad played four sets a night,
six days a week, for forty years.
Must've been really tiring, though,
your *show*. Was there a merch table
and everything?

Jimmy can't help but to laugh at the dig--this crowd doesn't suffer fools.

DIOGO

You storm into our house, drunk,
with crazy clown makeup on, on
Shabbat of all nights--

MICHAEL

On Shabbat--

DIOGO

You drink our booze, ruin our guest
towels--

MICHAEL

What towels? *Our* towels?

JIMMY

How'd you know about the towels--

DIOGO

Don't worry about the towels--I
don't care about the towels. Point
is. You ain't coming into this
house, taking up this much space,
and not leaving us with something.
On Shabbat.

TRINITY

Yeah, Johnny--it's Shabbat--

JIMMY

I'm Jimmy--

TRINITY

I'm pretty sure it's Johnny--

JIMMY

What?

LAUREL

Johnny, it is Shabbat--

JIMMY

(laughing)

I didn't know this was part of
Shabbat! This is my first one--I'm
not Jewish--

DIOGO

Most of us aren't Jewish--doesn't
mean we can't observe the sabbath--
or the rules of the home--

Jimmy exhales. Looks at the people, he's more intimidated by
this bunch than he is onstage in front of four-hundred fans.

JIMMY
Where's this ukulele?

INT. MUSES ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

It's WALL-TO-WALL beads, fabric, gemstones, feathers, it's a finely-curated craft store jammed into a ten-by-ten foot room. Diogo grabs a UKULELE from the corner.

JIMMY
Woah. What am I looking at here--

One wall is LINED WITH BEDAZZLED HIGH-HEELS. There's a table in the middle of the room with a sewing machine and glue gun.

Jimmy goes to the wall of shoes, picks one up, spots "MUSES 2012", notes all of them have dates and different elaborate decorations.

LAUREL
Diogo's mom rode with Muses.

JIMMY
Rode? Like a motorcycle gang?

LAUREL
First female Mardi Gras parade.
They toss shoes at the crowd--you
know how people try to catch beads
and stuff--

JIMMY
Right--

LAUREL
They do shoes. People freak for
them. They're highly coveted.

JIMMY
They're pretty.

DIOGO
Sometimes the ladies of Muses need
a bead or a stone or something, so
they come by, take something for
whatever they're working on--So in
a way she still gets to parade.

The opening ukulele notes of "*Laundromat*" come in...

INT. LIVING ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Jimmy plays the tune for the small crowd on the ukulele. He finishes the song. They applaud.

TRINITY

Yeah. I'm glad I didn't pay thirty-bucks for 90 minutes of that.

The guests crack up. Jimmy laughs.

EXT. BYWATER - LATER

They're approaching Hotel Peter and Paul, a giant church next door. Jimmy stops--

JIMMY

What kind of art--

LAUREL

Music, improv, sexy dancing--You were scared of clowns--how bad did that go?

JIMMY

I was a missionary. For the church.

LAUREL

Really?

JIMMY

Full on.

LAUREL

How full-on? Like those podcasts?

JIMMY

I did that for years--Played Christian music, met the girl, had Cecilia--

They're walking up the steps of the church--

LAUREL

This isn't--*church* church. It's weird art and the venue is a church. People have concerts and parties here. If you don't like it, we can leave--it's casual. Just say you want to leave and we'll go. But I think you'll like it.

They enter.

INT. CHURCH - MOMENTS LATER

It's beautiful. Hundred-foot ceilings. Gorgeous stained glass. One can't help but to be moved by the architecture. Jimmy enters behind Laurel as she says hi to familiar faces.

Characters walk around in GIANT MASKS, BIG PUPPETS, it all has a haunted, DIY, paper-maché Pee-Wee feel to it.

A woman strokes a harp as the guests enter. Jimmy gets in line at the bar as Laurel works the room.

Jimmy is watching Laurel from across the church as he gets to the front of the line--the BARTENDER, 40's, silver tooth, matter-of-fact-

BARTENDER
You love her?

Jimmy snaps out of it--

JIMMY
What?

BARTENDER
Do you love her?

JIMMY
Um.

BARTENDER
The girl you walked in with. You two seem very in love.

JIMMY
What makes you say that?

Bartender shrugs.

BARTENDER
Just a feeling, I guess.

JIMMY
Love?

BARTENDER
That I get from you two.

JIMMY
We just met.

BARTENDER
Plenty of time. Drink?

JIMMY

Yeah. Two tequila-sodas, please.
(BEAT) Want to do a shot with me?

BARTENDER

Sure.

Bartender pours two tequila shots.

BARTENDER (CONT'D)

Training wheels?

JIMMY

Huh?

BARTENDER

Limes?

Jimmy smiles.

JIMMY

I'm good. What did you mean plenty
of time--that we have--?

BARTENDER

To know by now.

They cheers and throw the shots back. Jimmy takes the drinks.

JIMMY

What do I owe you?

BARTENDER

They're free.

Jimmy drops some cash in the tip jar.

BARTENDER (CONT'D)

Cheers.

Jimmy approaches Laurel, she takes the drink--

LAUREL

Oh, thank you, sir--

JIMMY

Yeah.

She tugs on his shirt, looks him in the face--

LAUREL

Not too scary, huh?

JIMMY
Pretty in here--

LAUREL
Let's find some seats.

They move through the crowd and find seats. The lights dim.

A PERFORMER sits with an electric guitar. She is wearing a PLAIN WHITE MASK with a projector casting an image of TREES ON IT.

She starts in on a song "*Colina de Fe (Hill of Faith)*". It's a soft, melodic opening, after the intro, lights go up on the band to her side, the players all wear WHITE GOSPEL GOWNS.

The performer takes the mask off, it's Chelsea. Jimmy watches intently, starting to feel that mushroom dose.

A WOMAN WEARING A GLOBE costume, enters. It's a giant ball of a globe from neck to knees. A MAN, 20's-40's, follows her--

Someone wheels a DANCING POLE out to the middle of the floor.

The Globe JUMPS on the dancing pole, climbs to the top. She seductively slides down as the Man watches. A CROWD OF GUESTS AND OTHER PERFORMERS JOIN THE MAN AND GLOBE.

There is a SMALL FOUNTAIN sitting on a table, a FLORESCENT liquid comes from it. The performers take sips from it.

Time passes. It gets a bit trippy. Not too overwhelming, but that dose of mushrooms is apparent in both Laurel and Jimmy.

It's suddenly a wedding. The harpist gets up, sheds her gown, jumps on the pole, starts to pole dance. A DEMON-LOOKING CHARACTER ENTERS from behind the audience, walks down between the sections, spooks Jimmy--

JIMMY
Can we leave?

LAUREL
Yeah.

Laurel stands, eyes still on the show, they walk out as the song ends softly. An ORANGE LIGHT is projected behind them, and the SHADOW OF THE DEMON as they leave. The door closes.

EXT. PETER AND PAUL CHURCH - CONTINUOUS

They exit onto the steps. It's quiet. Nobody is around.

LAUREL

You okay? Get too horned up when
the sexy harpist got on the pole?

JIMMY

I think the mushrooms finally
kicked in. I'm not tripping--but
that was--trippy. I just needed to
be--not sitting in there. Sorry we
had to leave--

LAUREL

I think it was almost over, anyway.
I get it. I got horned up, too.

He laughs. Grabs the back of her shirt, kisses her. They
continue down the street.

They're approaching another corner with TWO BARS--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Drink?

JIMMY

Big fan of the things.

LAUREL

They have them here.

JIMMY

Look at that.

They approach Anna's, enter--

INT. ANNA'S - LATER

They enter, there's a STACK OF LOCAL INDIE NEWSPAPERS next to
the entrance. Laurel grabs one. There's a bar to the right,
pool table in back, bathrooms in the way-back, and a
staircase to an UPSTAIRS with different nightly programming.

They head for the bar. Jimmy notices a Muses shoe behind it--

JIMMY

A shoe.

Laurel flips through the paper--

LAUREL

You'll see them everywhere now.
Coconuts are Zulu.

JIMMY

Before I just would've thought it
was a shoe. It has a story. It's
more than a shoe.

LAUREL

Fuck, I am a tour guide. Shit.

She lands on the page she's looking for, hands it to him--He
gazes at the newspaper--

JIMMY

Oh, damn! It's you--

He scans it--

LAUREL

Yeah. Small piece.

JIMMY

(eyes on paper)
Coastal restoration--

LAUREL

There's an organization out here
that takes glass and turns it back
into sand to shore up the coast.

JIMMY

Genius. Can I read this later?

LAUREL

No, I want to watch you read the
whole thing right now. Please.

He laughs, rolls up the paper, puts it in his back pocket.

JIMMY

Shot?

LAUREL

Don't threaten me with a good time.

JIMMY

Two shots of--tequila, please--
Actually you want one?

Bartender nods--

BARTENDER

Why not.

Jimmy looks over, a familiar actor, HAMISH, 40's, SITS AT THE BAR WITH BLOOD ON HIS FACE AND NECK. He's staring at a martini in front of him, deep in thought--

JIMMY
Jesus--you alright, man?

Hamish snaps out of it, looks at Jimmy--

HAMISH
What? Oh, yeah--this is makeup.

JIMMY
Christ--

HAMISH
Yeah. I'm fine--

Hamish wipes some off with his hand, shows Jimmy--

JIMMY
Want a shot?

HAMISH
Sure thing.

Bartender pours four shots. They all cheers, take them.

HAMISH (CONT'D)
Actually--I'm not. I'm not fine.
I'm getting fat as fuck shooting
this movie here--

Jimmy turns back to him--

JIMMY
What?

HAMISH
Have you had the food here?

JIMMY
Some, yeah--good--

HAMISH
Fucking great--these fucking
sandwiches.

JIMMY
Poor boys?

HAMISH

Po'boys--the po'boys, YES. At first I just thought, oh, it's a sandwich. Great. Another sandwich specific to the geographic location I'm shooting this movie in--but where I thought it was just the southern version of a hoagie or a submarine sandwich--that's where I was dead wrong--it's so much more than that. Now that I have the justification that this sandwich I keep coming across has historical significance--I have to try every damn sandwich I come across--

Laurel leans over, tries to cue in--

LAUREL

--What's he talking about?--

JIMMY

--Sandwiches, I think--

HAMISH

I can't walk into a restaurant knowing they serve a po' boy and not order a po' boy--I've gained fifteen pounds in two weeks--I'm forty-percent body fat, ninety-percent po' boy--

Off Jimmy and Laurel--

HAMISH (CONT'D) (CONT'D)

Fried shrimp, fried oyster--half shrimp--half oyster--roast beef--turkey--dressed--undressed--

JIMMY

Why do they call it a Po' Boy--

HAMISH

Great question!

JIMMY

I'm sorry I asked--

LAUREL

Be right back--

Laurel spots someone across the room and ducks out, Jimmy stays put, watches her walk off. Hamish hammers on--

HAMISH

1929. Streetcar strikes. Streetcar workers demanded better working conditions and higher wages--so the city brought in strikebreakers from New York. The workers burned a streetcar--

JIMMY

Really?

HAMISH

Knocked it over and torched it. Two deaths--not bad, considering--

JIMMY

What's that have to do with a sandwich--

HAMISH

Everything! Martin's Café--they supported the striking streetcar workers by giving them free sandwiches. They took whatever they had around the restaurant and threw it in some french bread--whenever one of the striking workers would come by they'd shout--"*Here comes another poor boy!*"

JIMMY

Ah--

Jimmy connects with the bartender, smiles, Hamish has clearly been going on about this--

HAMISH

We wouldn't have this sandwich that is now synonymous with this city were it not for workers of the streetcar--a mode of transportation also synonymous with this city--protesting for better working conditions. The streetcar indirectly inspired the sandwich. You've heard of a protest song--this was a protest sandwich. The first of its kind. The only of its kind.

Jimmy sips from his drink, laughs. Scans the room for Laurel, doesn't see her--

HAMISH (CONT'D)
It's more than a sandwich.

JIMMY
It's more than a shoe.

HAMISH
Exactly. History is commonplace.

Jimmy laughs.

JIMMY
Did you see that girl I was with?

HAMISH
Gorgeous. How long you been
together?

JIMMY
Just met her.

HAMISH
Really?

JIMMY
Yeah--

HAMISH
Thought you were married.

JIMMY
Why?

HAMISH
I...don't know. That's not your
wife--?

JIMMY
What? No. You see where she went?

HAMISH
No clue.

JIMMY
I'm going to go find her.

HAMISH
Go find your wife. I'm going to
work on this.

He polishes off his martini. Jimmy walks off, not exactly
sure what he's "working on"--

HAMISH (CONT'D)
Protest sandwich, Jimmy! Protest sandwich!

JIMMY
How'd you know my name?

HAMISH
I know your shit, man. Big fan.

Jimmy laughs, walks off.

HAMISH (CONT'D)
(to bartender)
Another martini, please.

Hamish SLAMS his hand on the bar.

HAMISH (CONT'D)
I love this town.

Jimmy scans the bar. Doesn't see her anywhere. He finishes off his drink.

A funky-ass, scary, club remix of **"End of the Road"** comes in--

INT. ANNA'S - LATER

Jimmy moves through the bar--looking for Laurel. He passes the pool table, heads upstairs, gets to the second floor--an ENTIRELY DIFFERENT PARTY IS TAKING PLACE. It's RAGING.

Music is LOUD, it's dark, lights and fog cloud the room. Jimmy moves through, scanning faces--nothing.

He makes his way to the bar--no sign of Laurel--

JIMMY
(to bartender)
Can I get a tequila-soda, please?
Or--two--please--the Fortaleza,
thank you--

He waits. It's slammed. Bartender finally brings them. After a beat he takes a few sips. Then takes both and heads for the dance floor--pushes through sweaty bodies--

He spots someone in a plain white mask, light bouncing off it--

JIMMY (CONT'D)
Chelsea?

She pulls the mask off, it's Laurel's friend--

CHELSEA

Hey dude!

Jimmy looks at the group of friends, no Laurel, an intimate group dancing, including the Bartender from art church--

CHELSEA (CONT'D)

Thanks for coming to the show, man--

JIMMY

Yeah, for sure. Have you seen Laurel?

CHELSEA

Um. Yeah. I think she's around?

JIMMY

I walked in with her but I don't know where she went--

CHELSEA

She's probably around somewhere.

He stands with them for a bit, they continue to dance. After a little it starts to feel odd. He continues to search the room while they enjoy the party.

CHELSEA (CONT'D)

Maybe she's in the bathroom?

JIMMY

Right.

He's promptly excused. He downs one of the drinks so he doesn't have to hold both. He walks back toward the stairs-- notices a bathroom door to his right--heads in---

INT. BATHROOM - CONTINUOUS

He locks the door, puts his drink on top of the towel dispenser. Takes a piss, takes his phone out while he's peeing and rattles off a text. He flushes with his foot.

He washes his hands and exits.

INT. UPSTAIRS/STAIRWELL BAR - CONTINUOUS

He walks down the stairs to the other bathroom area--there's a line for the gender non-specific bathrooms. He gets in line, notices a PHOTOBOTH, pulls the curtain back, finds the Young Ripping Couple aggressively making out.

JIMMY

Sorry.

People exit the bathroom, he peers in, thinks he spots--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Laurel! Hey--?

Not her. No sign. He goes back to the first floor bar, scans the room, Hamish is gone. Jimmy doesn't know anyone in there. He leaves. The song fades out.

EXT. ANNA'S - MOMENTS LATER

Jimmy looks around outside, nothing. He pulls his phone out, dials, puts it to his ear--

JIMMY

Hey--it's Jimmy--not sure where you went off to. Gimme a ring.

He looks around. Spots Hamish down the street ordering food from an outdoor barbecue. Jimmy approaches--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Hey, man--

HAMISH

You hungry?

JIMMY

No--you see her anywhere out here?

HAMISH

Your wife?

JIMMY

...Yeah.

HAMISH

No. Sorry, I'll keep an eye out--
Want some of this?

Hamish holds out some chicken--

JIMMY

No thank you.

Jimmy walks back to the bar when he starts to hear YELLING. It sounds like Laurel. He looks around, doesn't see her.

He looks UP where he sees two people SHOUTING on the balcony of the second floor bar, above him, hands flailing, he can't make out the faces.

He takes a few steps back, trying to get a better view--

VOICE (O.C.)

Yo! Ay! HEY--YO WATCH OUT!!

Jimmy turns, and a PEDICAB ZOOMING PAST NAILS HIM, SENDS HIM TO THE GROUND--

JIMMY

Ow. Fuck.

The Pedicab swerves, stops--

PEDICAB

What the fuck!

The TWO DRUNK PASSENGERS in the pedicab YELP--

PEDICAB (CONT'D)

(to passengers)

You alright?

They rattle off version of "fine"--

Jimmy writhes, climbs to his feet--

JIMMY

Shit.

PEDICAB

You okay?

JIMMY

Yeah. My bad.

PEDICAB

Watch the fuck out.

JIMMY

Right.

He dusts himself off. SHOUTING brings his attention back to the balcony--it looks like Laurel. He enters the bar.

INT. ANNA'S - CONTINUOUS

He heads upstairs, pushes through the dancing crowd, past the dance floor, Chelsea spots him making his way to the balcony--

Jimmy connects with her as he walks through, it occurs to him she knew where Laurel was. He continues to the BALCONY DOOR--

EXT. BALCONY - CONTINUOUS

He steps out, peers down the balcony, sees Laurel in a SHOUTING MATCH with a GUY, 30's, he ducks around the corner to the other side of the balcony, out of sight.

He calms down. Catches his breath. He pulls a cigarette out, lights it. He listens from the other side of the balcony-- can't really make it out. Lover's quarrel.

GUY (O.C.)

Hey dude, can I get one of those--

Jimmy snaps out of it--looks up, gives a guy a cigarette--

GUY (CONT'D)

Thanks.

JIMMY

Yeah.

The shouting continues.

GUY

(re: shouting)

Fucking Anna's, dude. Place is crawling with my exes. Don't know why I bother coming here--

JIMMY

Maybe you want to run into them.

GUY

Definitely one of them. But she's never here.

JIMMY

Laurel?

GUY

Huh?

JIMMY

You know a girl named Laurel?

GUY

Don't think so. Maybe.

STOMPING comes from off-camera--

LAUREL (O.C.)
Thank you in advance for not
contacting me! DO NOT INTERACT WITH
ME! IF YOU SEE ME IN PUBLIC, TURN
AWAY!

The stomping gets closer until a BIG DUDE emerges from the
other side and goes back inside. He shoots Jimmy and the Guy
a look and a head shake as he enters--

There's a beat. Jimmy doesn't move, just stands there. We
hear Laurel approaching, she rounds the corner, reaches for
the door, spots Jimmy--

LAUREL (CONT'D)
Oh--shit.

JIMMY
Everything alright?

LAUREL
Did you hear that?

JIMMY
Some of it.

GUY
Oh, hey, I know you--we matched on
Hinge--

Laurel looks at him--

LAUREL
What? No we didn't--

GUY
I think we did.

LAUREL
We definitely didn't.

GUY
I liked you on Hinge--

LAUREL
That's not a match--

JIMMY
Read the room, guy--

GUY
Yeah. I should get outta here.
Thanks for the smoke.

Guy looks around the balcony two beats too long, flicks his cigarette off the balcony, then leaves.

JIMMY

You okay?

A VOICE from below the balcony--

VOICE (O.C.)

(re cigarette)

What the fuck! Watch out!

LAUREL

We should've skipped this one. Our only miss of the night. And we were doing so well.

JIMMY

I got a great history lesson on sandwiches.

Off Laurel's short exhale of a laugh...

EXT. MARIGNY - LATER

They're walking in silence--

LAUREL

Sorry about that. That was an ex.

JIMMY

I sure hope so.

She laughs--

LAUREL

I shouldn't have brought you there--
It was a karmic run-in--

JIMMY

Trying to avoid him?

LAUREL

Always. And we could've, we could've easily avoided him, gone across the street. But I knew there'd be a stack of Antigravities next to the door and I wanted to casually flip through to my article as a flex--to show off to you--

JIMMY

Really?!

LAUREL

Then of course I run into King Ding-Dong.

JIMMY

We've had a lot of hits, we were due for a miss--

Off her look--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

I'm glad I got a copy of the article.

She smiles.

JIMMY (CONT'D)

Musician?

LAUREL

What?

JIMMY

Your ex.

LAUREL

Oh, yea--how'd you know--

JIMMY

He had a drum key on his keychain attached to his pants.

LAUREL

Oh, god.

JIMMY

Seems like a lot to have on your waistband, I don't know--

LAUREL

He's such a poser--

JIMMY

Sorry-I'm not trying to rag on him--

LAUREL

I am.

Jimmy laughs.

JIMMY

Thing for musicians?

LAUREL

I'm wondering that right now in this moment, actually. I think I just like people who like things--passionate about something. Nascar. Ceramics. Whatever. But--Yes, the life of a musician or artist, perhaps I'm more attracted to that--than other forms, of interest...passion.

JIMMY

Glass-blowing...

LAUREL

Right. Haven't dated one of those yet. Musicians? Plenty. Ones that actually play? Few.

JIMMY

Lot of talk?

LAUREL

Him? All talk. Never played. Always talked about recording. Touring. Nothing. Maybe a show or a practice here or there--

JIMMY

Fuck. Am I a ploy--did I just get used---

LAUREL

What? No!--

JIMMY

Am I ex bait?

LAUREL

Not at all! Did he see us together? Yes. Was he pissed? Yes. Does you being a musician make that worse for him? Certainly. Will he find that out? Probably. Was that all intentional? No. Socially convenient for me? Maybe a little.

He laughs. They walk for a beat in silence--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

I did say yes to a date because of the tour thing--with you--

JIMMY

Now it comes out--

LAUREL

Seemed like a lay-up. Super low floor and high ceiling. No strings. No pressure. Would make the ex jealous. Maybe make me feel good. Worst case scenario you're lame and I bail, best case, well--

Off Jimmy--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

You're not bad.

He smiles. She grabs his hand.

The opening notes to Professor Longhairs "Go to the Mardi Gras" play as the HORN of a GOLF CART ZIPS UP to them--

Behind the wheel is SCOTT, 40's, french quarter artist, sitting passenger is RJ, 30's, dresses like vintage Eminem--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

What's up, girls?

SCOTT

Just did a lap on the fruit loop--

LAUREL

How was that--

JIMMY

--Fruit loop?--

LAUREL

Gay bars--

RJ

Same old shit. We're going to Anna's--

LAUREL

We just came from there--

RJ

How was it--

LAUREL

Skip it--

JIMMY

She got in a ripper with her ex--

SCOTT
Shocker.

LAUREL
Fuck off, I'm on a date--

SCOTT
That's shocking. I'm shocked.

Laurel laughs. RJ heads for the liquor store behind them--

RJ
I'm getting tequila, anything else?

SCOTT
Mixers.

Rj dips inside--

SCOTT (CONT'D)
There's a show at Le Bon Temps--

Laurel shoots Jimmy a look--

LAUREL
You should probably get a taste of
uptown. There's an old Irish
neighborhood. Irish Channel.

JIMMY
I'm not going to say no--

LAUREL
(to Scott)
Can she make the trip?

Laurel lightly kicks the golf-cart tire--

SCOTT
Gas, baby. Off-road tires.

Benjamin Booker's *"A Place for Us"* comes in...

INT. LE BON TEMPS - CONTINUOUS

Benjamin Booker performs the track. An intimate crowd takes
in the performance.

Throughout the song we cut between the golf cart making the
trip uptown and the performance.

The scenery changes from the French Quarter, through the Central Business District, to the Garden District, streets lined with beautiful haunting live oaks.

INT. LE BON TEMPS - CONTINUOUS

We find Jimmy and Laurel in the crowd towards the end.

INT. LE BON TEMPS - LATER

HOWE, 30's, in clown makeup and a cowboy hat (performer from the clown show earlier) spots Laurel and b-lines for her--

 HOWE
Shit. Laurel. Wow, great news--

 LAUREL
You're still in your makeup!

 HOWE
Always--

 LAUREL
Howe is in Clownsystem.

 JIMMY
Oh, damn, great show, man--fun stuff.

 HOWE
Thank you--

 JIMMY
I'm Scruples.

 HOWE
What?

 JIMMY
From earlier. I was Scruples. From before.

 HOWE
Oh.

Laurel laughs.

 JIMMY
Never mind.

LAUREL

He's trying to say he did his own
makeup for the show earlier.

She pats Jimmy on the shoulder.

HOWE

Yeah?! Nice, man. Good job, you did
it.

JIMMY

Yeah. Scruples. I did it.

Laurel thinks this dumbass exchange is hilarious.

LAUREL

Are you playing--

HOWE

Solo set, some covers and shit--I
need you to sing on one--

Jimmy shoots her a look--

HOWE (CONT'D)

--I'm doing that Love Hurts cover--
you've done it before--Jesse was
supposed to sing but he got too
fucked up and shit--he's passed out
in my car--I cracked the window--
but, anyway, please--

LAUREL

Yeah. Okay. Sure.

HOWE

Oh my god. Thank you so much.

JIMMY

You play?

HOWE

She sings.

LAUREL

Everyone sings.

HOWE

It's beautiful.

HOWE (CONT'D)

Stay in the high register and
shit--go up at the end of the
verses instead of--you know--

LAUREL

Yeah, yeah, yeah--

They enter...

INT. LE BON TEMPS - MOMENTS LATER

Howe is on the stage, a small audience, he stands there alone with a bass.

HOWE

A friend of mine is going to join
me for this one. Please welcome
Laurel Bernfeld to the stage--

Claps, Laurel walks up, connects with Jimmy, the most visibly surprised and excited we've seen him all night--

Howe starts in, it's a broken down version of "*Love Hurts*", it's just the bass line.

Laurel's vocal comes in, it's gorgeous. Jimmy is stunned.

It's a famous song, done by many, but this cover of just the simple bass and two-vocal harmony feels different. It feels like The Everly Brothers are covering The Everly Brothers.

It ends. Applause, Laurel exits the stage, like it's nothing. She seems relieved, at peace. She approaches Jimmy--

JIMMY

Are you fucking kidding me?

EXT. LE BON TEMPS - MOMENTS LATER

We're close on her face, as Jimmy speaks excitedly--

JIMMY (O.C.)

Ridiculous! After this whole
fucking night! All night! I've been
playing my shit--I've been
auditioning--and you--

She reaches off-camera, grabs his cigarette, takes a drag-- hands it back, we reverse to him as he leans into her--

LAUREL

Glad you didn't hate it.

JIMMY

Amazing.

Scott and RJ come up--

RJ
YO. That was so good.

SCOTT
Imagine if we didn't pick you up--
Howe would've been left out to try--

LAUREL
Some New Orleans symbiosynthesis
for you--

Out walks Benny Poppins, New Orleans famous, can't walk down
the street without being stopped.

LAUREL (CONT'D)
Oh, Benny Poppins!

BENNY
Hey ya'll--

LAUREL
What's up?

BENNY
I gotta go do my radio show--

Laurel shoots Jimmy a knowing look.

EXT. MALL - LATER

Benny, Laurel, and Jimmy walk through the parking lot. The
Creole Queen docked in the river in the distance.

INT. MALL - MOMENTS LATER

They enter, it's empty. Bright lights. Strange to be in a
mall late at night/early in the morning with no one in it.

They head for the elevator. We watch them zip up the
transparent tube. The elevator opens onto WWOZ.

INT. WWOZ - CONTINUOUS

They enter the pristine studio--

BENNY
Welcome to O-Z.

Jimmy takes in the beautiful station. In a town where potholes are filled with gravel and seashells (if at all), and telephone cables are held together with duct tape, this station is a product of patience and perseverance.

BENNY (CONT'D)

Brand new studio. Check it out--

Benny leads them to the live room, where we saw Los Guiros playing in the opening--

Jimmy takes it in, spots a Muses shoe on someone's desk.

JIMMY

Our manager couldn't get us in here.

BENNY

Really?

Jimmy looks at the photos of previous studios, from a beer storage room at Tipitina's to a treehouse in Armstrong Park.

JIMMY

Yeah, we wanted to play before the show.

BENNY

Want to do a song?

JIMMY

Now?

BENNY

Sure. This late at night, safe harbor, I can do whatever I want. Ya'll just need to help me dial in the backline.

JIMMY

Yeah, I mean--I wish I had my band--

LAUREL

Doesn't have his band, doesn't have his guitar, doesn't have his mouthguard in---

Off Jimmy's look--

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Call them--

JIMMY

They're probably asleep.

LAUREL

Your sister wasn't going to sleep
anytime soon.

Jimmy pulls his phone out. Benny and Laurel walk into the other room, scan the vinyl collection. Jimmy watches her through the window--

JIMMY

Penny--what are you doing--

INT. BAR - SAME

Penny, with some remnants of her clown makeup still on, is at a bar with some new friends--

PENNY

About to sign a lease here--

Penny is holding hands with someone. We cut back-and-forth between her and Jimmy--

JIMMY

Come to the radio station, they're
going to let us play one--

PENNY

At four AM?

JIMMY

Yeah.

PENNY

Cool.

Penny takes a shot, downs her drink--

They hang up, Jimmy tries to call the other band mates, no dice, then rattles off a few texts.

He enters the other room--

JIMMY

I think they're on their way--

BENNY

Got any solo stuff you want to do
before they get here--?

Jimmy looks at the studio--

JIMMY

Sure. It's not like I'm a precious bitch or anything.

LAUREL

That's the spirit!

INT. STUDIO - MOMENTS LATER

He sits on a stool, picks up the guitar--

BENNY

Benny Poppins here and I'm joined by Jimmy of The Troubles, he's going to play a quick one solo as we wait for his band to arrive. Thanks for being here, Jimmy--

JIMMY

Hey, yeah. Thanks for having me. Good evening, good morning. Happy to be here--it's so nice.

BENNY

You got one for us?

JIMMY

Yeah. Yeah. This one's called Every Night.

He starts in on "**Every Night**"--

JIMMY (CONT'D)

I've been feeling like you don't care anymore, baby...

EXT. BAR - CONTINUOUS

Penny struggles to find an Uber, the new friend she is with flags down a Pedicab. They hop in. The song plays on the radio station in the pedicab--

PENNY

Shit, turn it up--that's Jimmy--

EXT. FRENCHMAN STREET - CONTINUOUS

We find Darren through the window of a TATTOO SHOP, getting some work done. He pulls out his phone--reacts to the text--

DARREN

What--

INT. HOTEL - CONTINUOUS

Zach is sound asleep.

INT. TATTOO SHOP - CONTINUOUS

Darren is on the phone--

DARREN

(to artist)

How much longer you think?

TATTOO ARTIST

Want me to rush it?

DARREN

No--

TATTOO ARTIST

Almost done.

DARREN

I'll give you twenty bucks to give
me a ride to WWOZ after.

Tattoo Artist looks at his watch--

TATTOO ARTIST

Fifty.

INT. WWOZ STUDIO - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy continues, Benny and Laurel watch from the other room--

BENNY

This isn't bad.

LAUREL

Thank fucking god.

Benny laughs.

JIMMY

*Maybe I should've got a real job.
Yeah, I am meditating, but can I
switch my mind up?*

EXT. TATTOO SHOP - CONTINUOUS

Darren and the Tattoo Artist exit the shop and walk to his ride. It's not a car. It's an E-BIKE.

DARREN
Do you have helmets?

TATTOO ARTIST
Dude. Just get an Uber.

DARREN
Nah, this looks fun. No traffic.
Let's hit it.

Darren gets on.

EXT. WWOZ PARKING LOT - CONTINUOUS

Penny's pedicab zooms up, she tosses the driver some cash, gets out with her new friend.

PENNY
Is this a fucking mall--

FRIEND
Come on--

EXT. FRENCH QUARTER - CONTINUOUS

Darren grabs onto the Tattoo Artist, as they rip on his E-Bike down the sidewalk along the Mississippi. The song still playing. A GIANT SHIP passes down the river behind them.

INT. MALL - CONTINUOUS

Penny and her friend enter the bright empty mall.

PENNY
This is a fucking mall! We're in a
mall?!

Penny thinks it's hilarious.

INT. STUDIO - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy spots Penny as she enters the station, Darren shortly after. He's finishing up the song. Laurel lets them in.

They take in the space. Enamored by the Jazz Fest posters and history on the walls.

JIMMY

*I've been trying forever to feel
you out/I can never explain it,
everything's changing.*

The band sets up as Jimmy finishes the tune.

BENNY

That was Every Night by Jimmy
Brown. Wow. James Brown. I just
realized that. I have James Brown
in my studio.

JIMMY

Yeah. The wrong one. Sorry,
everybody.

BENNY

(laughing/nodding)
Maybe not the James Brown, but a
James Brown nonetheless. One from
The Troubles coming up--

In the studio room--

PENNY

Like a Ghost?

JIMMY

Yeah. Let's try it.

DARREN

Really? You look lit.

Penny's pupils are huge.

PENNY

I am. Let's see the tattoo--

Darren shows his arm--some cowboy tattoo--

JIMMY

You just got that?

DARREN

Chyea. Like A Ghost? Really?

PENNY

What about the harmony--

Jimmy looks to Laurel across the glass--waves her over.

JIMMY
Try one with us?

LAUREL
Really?

PENNY
Fuck is this the date? (to Darren)
Are we on the date--

Darren shrugs. Jimmy ignores her.

JIMMY
I got jealous watching you sing
with that guy. And fight with your
ex.

PENNY
Fuck. This is the date. This is for
sure the date. We are on it.

DARREN
What did you take?

PENNY
Everything. I took it all.

Laurel laughs.

JIMMY
You can't practice and not preach--
or--you know what I mean. Here I am--
--practicing the practice-as you
said--of the town--

PENNY
Right on, man--yeah, listen to him--
he's so sweet? Don't you love him?
I love him. He's so sweet.

Penny is lit up. Laurel laughs.

LAUREL
Alright. Alright.

Jimmy takes a sharpie from a music stand, jots the lyrics
down on a piece of paper--he starts quietly singing them so
she can get an idea for the melody--

ZACH (O.C.)
Hey--

They look up, Zach is standing there--

DARREN
Where the fuck did you come from?

ZACH
Hotel. Did I miss it?

DARREN
How'd you get in here?

ZACH
Door was open.

Zach picks up the bass from the backline.

BENNY
We're joined now by The Troubles--
what's up for us, ya'll look like
you've gotten well acquainted with
the city in one way or another--

Penny leans into the mic--

PENNY
Shit yeah. Happy to be here. I saw
a bunch of clowns play LSD--LCD--
Sound--Clownsystem earlier--I saw
the clowns--

Jimmy and Laurel exchange a look--

PENNY (CONT'D)
--two hours later I saw Little
Freddie King, now I'm here--and
I'll definitely remember this
experience because I'm seeing
triple.

The room cracks up. Benny wasn't anticipating that--

JIMMY
This is a new one. It was called
Like A Ghost. Maybe we'll change it
to Seeing Triple.

PENNY
Triple. At least.

BENNY
Have you seen any ghosts since you
been here?

PENNY
Yeah, in our fucking dressing room!-
-Fuck, can I curse--

BENNY
Sort of, try not to--

PENNY
We all saw one! Remember?

The band laughs--

BENNY
(laughing)
This one's called Triple at Least
by The Troubles--

The guitar starts....

JIMMY
*Now that you're gone, where am I to
be? Don't you remember, how it used
to feel? And now I'm a stranger, as
far as you see...*

Jimmy cues Laurel, her vocal comes in--

JIMMY/LAUREL
*Was it all in my head/Was any of it
real? Was it all in my head/How am
I supposed to feel?*

The rest of the band smiles, surprised by the harmony. Jimmy
and Laurel fumble a line or two, brush it off--

JIMMY
*When you left me for dead, now I
sit on the floor. Like a ghost, I
have nothing, that I had before...*

We watch the entire performance in studio. The band is drunk
but dialed. Laurel makes her way through the song gracefully,
it's all very organic but impressive. Honest, stripped.

JIMMY/LAUREL
*Like a ghost I have nothing, that I
had before...*

The song ends.

EXT. RIVERWAY - LATER

They walk in silence as the sun starts to creep up--

LAUREL
There's not much walking me across
that river.

JIMMY

What?

LAUREL

I live in Algiers--other side of
the Mississippi--

JIMMY

After all that, you don't even live
in New Orleans?

LAUREL

New frontier. Old frontier.

JIMMY

How you getting home?

LAUREL

Ferry.

JIMMY

I think a boat trip is all I need
to round out my southern experience
here--

LAUREL

Maybe next time.

They've made it to the ferry terminal. A FERRY WORKER, 20's,
opens the gate--there's a smattering of people nearby
waiting, yawning--

JIMMY

Jesus, that's it?

LAUREL

You come with me, you're going to
miss your ride.

JIMMY

I didn't get a proper warning.
Twelve hours later and we come to a
screeching halt--

LAUREL

You have my number.

He smiles. They kiss. Neither sure if this is the last time
they'll see each other. They separate--

JIMMY

I had a really great time and I
didn't expect to. I feel pretty
fortunate. Lucky, even.

LAUREL

Yeah. We're lucky. That's for damn sure.

JIMMY

I felt like-I--we were coasting.
Like we were on a river all night.

LAUREL

Some horny body of water.

She turns her gaze to the Mississippi. He laughs. We're in a two shot of them standing in front of it.

LAUREL (CONT'D)

Fun night.

JIMMY

I don't want that for just one night. I want that every single night.

LAUREL

Every single night?

FERRY WORKER

Ya'll getting on?

Jimmy looks up, the early light catches his eye--

LAUREL

I should go.

JIMMY

I mean--

Jimmy turns, looks towards the quarter, his hotel. He looks at the ferry, at her--

LAUREL

You should go, too.

He puts his hands on his knees, nearly doubled over, exasperated by having to make this decision.

JIMMY

I haven't left your side all night.
What if I get lost?

LAUREL

Give me a call.

JIMMY

I will. I will.

LAUREL
Seeya Irish Jimmy.

JIMMY
Bye, Laurel.

They kiss and separate.

She walks down the platform, he watches her leave.

As she approaches the ferry she turns and throws him the same look she did when they first stumbled on each other in the quarter.

She boards. The ferry revs up and peels away from the dock.

He turns and walks off, tries to collect himself, isn't having much luck.

EXT. FRENCH QUARTER - EARLY MORNING

He walks through town. IV Waste is hosing down the streets, re-painting posts, the same way they do it at Disneyland every single night. Daily maintenance.

Jimmy watches as half the town goes to sleep, the other half wakes up.

He suddenly stops. He turns, peers into the window, spots a small ACOUSTIC GUITAR. He looks into the shop, sees someone behind the register.

INT. PAWN SHOP - MOMENTS LATER

He's at the register, paying for a guitar, case open.

EXT. FRENCH QUARTER - LATER

Jimmy passes by the Busker from the opening that covered his song, he's heading home after a long night--

JIMMY
Patrick--right?

PATRICK
Hey, man--

JIMMY
How's it?

PATRICK
Yeah, good. Long one. You?

JIMMY
Yeah. Sorta came at me out of
nowhere.

Patrick senses something. Jimmy looks back toward the river,
tries to shake the feeling off. He looks down at the guitar--

JIMMY (CONT'D)
Here--

Jimmy hands it to him--

PATRICK
Seriously?

JIMMY
No room in the van.

PATRICK
Shit, thanks man. She's pretty.

JIMMY
Take it easy.

INT. HOTEL BATHROOM - LATER

Jimmy is in the shower. Washing his night off. Face paint and
glitter running down the drain.

INT. HOTEL ROOM - LATER

He's putting clothes on. Packs his bag, leaves the hotel room
he didn't sleep in.

EXT. HOTEL - MOMENTS LATER

Jimmy walks through the lobby, bags packed. He finds his band
huddled around a sitting area, drinking the bad lobby coffee.
He spots a Muses shoe behind the concierge desk.

PENNY
Get any sleep?

JIMMY
Fuck no. You?

PENNY

Don't think so. But I've been
dreaming, big brother. I've been
dreaming.

He laughs. Andrew approaches--

ANDREW

Where's Carl?

The band shrugs--

EXT. HOTEL - CONTINUOUS

They exit, peer around, looking for the sprinter.

ANDREW

Motherfucker.

Andrew pulls his phone out. After a beat the sprinter comes
ZOOMING UP, nails a trash can. Straightens out.

Andrew peers in at Carl--definitely had a long night.

ANDREW (CONT'D)

Are you cool?

CARL

I'm cool, man.

ANDREW

Actually?

CARL

I'm fucking cool, man. Get in the
van. Let's go.

They load in. A bit hesitant. Carl doesn't seem cool.

CARL (CONT'D)

That trash can came outta nowhere.

EXT. HIGHWAY - LATER

They drive in silence. Carl merges onto a highway. Jimmy is
scrolling through his phone.

EXT. BRIDGE - LATER

The sprinter makes it's way over a body of water--

DARREN
Is that the Mississippi?

ANDREW
Lake Pontchartrain.

PENNY
Oh--fuck--that's what that song's
about--Lakes of Pontchartrain--

Jimmy nods, smiles, half-asleep against the window.

CARL
(re body of water)
I think it's the Mississippi.

ANDREW
If it's the Mississippi we're going
the wrong way.

CARL
I think we're going the wrong way.

ANDREW
Did you sleep?

CARL
No.

ANDREW
Are you drunk?

CARL
No.

ANDREW
Pull over. I'm driving.

CARL
Fair.

Jimmy looks out off the bridge. Spots the ferry going to Algiers.

JIMMY
Where are we?

ANDREW
Carl went on a bender last night,
now we're going the wrong way.

CARL
My bad.

JIMMY
Is that the ferry?

Jimmy looks around. Nobody knows, or answers.

Irma Thomas and Galactic's "How Glad I Am" comes in. The opening that sounds like a BOAT HORN takes us to...

EXT. FERRY - CONTINUOUS

Water laps against the stern of the ferry. As the vocal comes in we find Laurel, sitting on the outdoor deck. She's smiling, laughing to herself.

We angle on Jackson Square and the St. Louis Cathedral behind her. Seagulls coasting on the boat's windstream.

We see the bridge in the background, the sprinter heading in the same direction.

EXT. HIGHWAY/ROADSIDE - MOMENTS LATER

The sprinter merges off the highway and parks on the side of the road. Andrew and Carl get out to switch seats. As they pass each other--

ANDREW
You have one fucking job!

They're distracted as Jimmy gets out, looks around, crosses the street to a GAS STATION.

Over the song we dip in on other faces from throughout the night as the early morning sun spills over town--

-BENNY POPPINS drives home to his one-bedroom apartment.

-YOUNG RIPPING COUPLE gets into bed, half-naked, fully drunk.

-THE SATURN BAR BARTENDERS close out, clean. Clownpocalypse.

-THE ST. CHARLES COUPLE have left their porch. Empty chairs and dirty glasses.

INT. GAS STATION - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy is at the register a CLERK, 20's-70's, helps him--

CLERK

Make a left out here, about five,
six blocks--up over a little ridge.
You'll see the tower. Yellow tower.

JIMMY

Five blocks, yellow tower. Thanks.

He walks out.

INT. SPRINTER - SAME

Andrew is in the driver's seat--puts the van in drive, goes
to merge into the street--

PENNY

Woah, woah--Jimmy's not here--

ANDREW

What?

Andrew cranes his neck--

ANDREW (CONT'D)

Where'd he go?

PENNY

I think he went to take a leak or
something--

EXT. GAS STATION - CONTINUOUS

Penny gets out of the sprinter, spots Jimmy walking the
opposite direction--

PENNY

Jimmy!

He keeps walking.

PENNY (CONT'D)

James!

No luck.

EXT. FERRY - CONTINUOUS

Laurel waits as the ferry pulls into Algiers.

EXT. ALGIERS POINT - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy walks through the neighborhood.

INT. SPRINTER - CONTINUOUS

Penny climbs back in--

PENNY
He's walking down the street.

DARREN
What's he doing?

PENNY
No clue.

EXT. FERRY PORT - CONTINUOUS

Laurel gets off, walks up the ramp, gets over the levy, heads down the street.

EXT. ALGIERS POINT - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy spots the yellow tower, makes his way toward the levy. He spots a few people getting off.

Laurel is walking down the block behind him in the opposite direction.

He gets to the top of the ferry ramp, scans the people getting off. No luck. He stays for a beat, looks around.

He turns, just as she disappears down the block.

INT. SPRINTER - CONTINUOUS

Penny takes her phone out. Dials.

EXT. ALGIERS POINT - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy picks up his phone--

JIMMY
Yeah. I'm down the block. Down that street. Sorry.

He hangs up. Takes one last look. Everywhere. He walks in the direction of the sprinter.

LAUREL (O.C.)
You lost?

He turns, spots her across the road. He deflates a bit.

JIMMY
I was told to meet my tour guide
here.

Off her look--

LAUREL
There's a bar down the street.

He looks to his right, sees the van in the distance. He looks
back to her--

JIMMY
Don't threaten me with a good time.

He walks towards her. We stay in the same shot. She reaches
her hand out. He takes it.

They kiss. They walk down the block. Camera doesn't move.

After a beat the sprinter follows.

Professor Longhair's "Big Chief" comes in.

Cut to black.

THE END